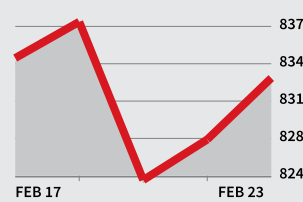


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 83294.66 (+479.95)

IN FOCUS



	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	25713.00	+141.75
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	22.87	+0.13
US Dollar (in ₹)	90.88	-0.10
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	157586.00	+3141
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	264075.00	+13761

MARKET CONCERNS.

SEBI will review brokers' concerns on the RBI's revised funding and collateral norms after industry representations **p6**



EXPORT SETBACK.

Govt halves RoDTEP benefits, raising concerns amid global uncertainty & US tariff pressure **p7**

QUICKLY.

CREDIT PUSH

Airtel to put ₹20,000 cr in NBFC Airtel Money

Mumbai: Telecom service provider Bharti Airtel will invest ₹20,000 crore in its non-banking financial company, Airtel Money Ltd, to rapidly expand its credit engine. Airtel will contribute 70 per cent of the investment, while the promoter group, through Bharti Enterprises, will provide the rest. **p2**

FISCAL STRATEGY

NMP 2.0 eyes ₹16.7 lakh cr asset monetisation

New Delhi: The Centre plans to monetise ₹16.72 lakh crore assets under the National Monetisation Pipeline 2.0, launched by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman. NMP 2.0 eyes ₹16.72 lakh crore asset monetisation in FY26-30. **p7**

IN SUPREME COURT...

WhatsApp denies sharing data with Meta platforms

New Delhi: Instant messaging platform WhatsApp maintained in the Supreme Court on Monday that it is not "quite right" to say the online entity is sharing data with other Meta platforms. It said it would fully comply with the NCLAT directions relating to user consent for sharing data by March 16. **p10**

IDFC First Bank appoints KPMG to probe ₹590 cr fraud

BIG HIT. Collusion of staff with private parties suspected; bank stock plunges 20%

Piyush Shukla
Mumbai

IDFC First Bank on Monday said it has appointed KPMG as the forensic auditor to investigate the ₹590 crore fraud at its Chandigarh branch, involving Haryana government accounts.

The bank's MD and CEO, V Vaidyanathan, said the lender will "spare no one" as it suspected that employees had colluded with external parties to commit the fraud.

"... Clearly a case of employee fraud... and our internal details show external parties are also involved... this was a physical transaction where cheques were forged. This is the oldest kind of fraud probably known to banking," Vaidyanathan said.

"How this happened is obviously through the connivance of employees. Maker, checker and authoriser systems exist but a group of people came together and made it happen. We will get to the bottom of this. We will spare no one," he said.

According to the bank management, Haryana gov-

HOW IT OCCURRED

- IDFC First Bank received a request from a Haryana government department to close an account and transfer the balance, but found the transfer amount not matching the account balance

- Upon review, the bank detected that certain branch employees, possibly in collusion with external parties, had fraudulently diverted funds from the State government's deposit account to beneficiaries holding accounts outside the bank

- The management said branch staff passed irregular entries and transferred funds from the client account to external parties. External entities also encashed cheques that now appear to be forged, but these were cleared by branch employees



ernment funds account for 0.5 per cent of IDFC First Bank's overall deposits of ₹2.82 lakh crore.

GOVT DEPOSITS

The State government has already withdrawn ₹200 crore and de-empanelled the bank from undertaking State government business, which will lead to complete outflow of government deposits from the bank.

While the bank estimates

a ₹590-crore impact on its balance sheet due to the fraud, final net impact will depend on total recoveries, insurance and extra claims.

IDFC First Bank's shares hit the lower circuit after falling 20 per cent intra-day.

Vaidyanathan said hereon the bank will approve cheque-based transactions above a certain threshold only after the transaction gets approved by the customer.

The lender will use AI for primary verification of large ticket transactions.

AU SFB ISSUE

AU Small Finance Bank, recently de-empanelled from handling Haryana government business, said a State department opened an account with an initial ₹25 crore transferred from a private bank, followed by ₹47 crore received through multiple transactions from IDFC First Bank.

More reports p2

'No systemic risk'

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Responding to the ₹590-crore IDFC First Bank fraud, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said the issue does not pose any systemic risk and that the central bank is keeping an eye on the developments. "We are watching the developments and there is no systemic issue," he said during a press briefing here.

Details p2

DTAC revamp gives France dividend relief, India tax rights

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

India and France have signed the protocol to make changes to the Double Taxation Avoidance Convention (DTAC), said the Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) on Monday.

According to a CBDT statement, the amending protocol provides India full taxing rights in respect of capital gains arising from the sale of shares of a company to the jurisdiction where the company is located. It deletes the so-called most-favoured nation clause from the DTAC protocol.

DIVIDEND TAX

It modifies the taxation of income from dividends by replacing a single rate of 10 per cent of tax with a split rate of 5 per cent for those holding at least 10 per cent of capital and 15 per cent of tax for all other cases. It also modifies the definition of fees for technical services by aligning it with the definition in the India-US Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement, and expands the scope of permanent establishment by adding service PE.

Read more p3

Focus on core business, don't mis-sell: FM to banks

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday once again asked banks to focus on the core business while saying that they are spending more time on selling insurance.

She also said that it is too early to comment on the impact of the tariff changes announced by the US.

"Banks should concentrate on their core business. My pet peeve has always been... 'you're spending more time selling insurance when it is not required' and, conveniently, it fell between two stools (of the RBI and IRDAI)," she said while addressing a press conference after the customary post-Budget address to the Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India. She expressed satisfaction with the RBI's draft proposal on checking the mis-selling.

"The message should go to banks that you cannot afford to mis-sell. Mis-selling is an offence," Sitharaman said. "Why should a customer asking for home loan with collateral take another insurance cover? Glad the RBI clarified to banks that they cannot mis-sell," she added.

Further, she said that the emphasis has been on mobil-



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

ising deposits and lending, which is the core business.

Banks have not mobilised enough CASA (current account and savings account) deposits but have reached a point where there is no comfort on the CASA level. "When banks approached me earlier, I told them I will not give money for their requirements; instead they needed to prioritise raising CASA funds," she said.

US TARIFF IMPACT

Asked about the impact of the US tariff changes on the Indian economy, Sitharaman said it is a "bit too soon" to comment. "But on the trade particularly... the Commerce Ministry is reviewing the situation. The delegation will have to take a call when they go for further negotiations," she said.

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Shri U. R. Chinnusamy
(04.06.1931 - 24.02.2009)
Founder Chairman, URC Group



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LIFE INSURANCE CORPORATION OF INDIA

Har Pal Aapke Saath

India, France sign protocol to amend double taxation treaty

END TO DISPUTES. Most-favoured nation clause has been deleted from the protocol

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

India and France have signed the protocol to make changes to the Double Taxation Avoidance Convention (DTAC), said the Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) on Monday. According to a statement by the board, the amending protocol provides full taxing rights in respect of capital gains arising from sale of shares of a company to the jurisdiction where the company is situated. It deletes the so-called most-favoured nation (MFN) clause from the protocol to the DTAC, thereby bringing to rest all issues relating to it.

DIVIDEND TAX
The amending protocol modifies the taxation of income from dividends by replacing a single rate of 10 per cent of tax, with a split rate of 5 per cent for those holding at least 10 per cent of capital and 15 per cent of tax for all other cases. It also modifies the definition of fees for technical services by aligning it with the definition in India US Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement, and expands the scope of permanent establishment by adding service PE.

The amending protocol updates the provisions on exchange of information and introduces a new article on assistance in collection of taxes, according to international standards. “This will

NEW FRAMEWORK

- Provides full taxing rights in respect of capital gains arising from sale of shares of a company, to the resident jurisdiction of the company
- Modifies the taxation of income from dividends by replacing a single rate of 10% of tax with a split rate of 5% for those holding at least 10% of capital and 15% for all other cases
- Tweaks the definition of fees for technical services by aligning it with the definition in India-US DTAA, and expands the scope of 'permanent establishment' by adding service PE clause



facilitate seamless exchange of information and strengthen mutual tax co-operation between India and France,” said the statement. The changes introduced through the amending protocol will come into effect subsequent to the completion of internal procedures under the laws of both the countries and subject to the terms agreed between the two countries. “The amending protocol updates the India-France DTAC to the latest international standards, in a manner that balances the interests of India and France, and updates it in accordance with international standards,” it said.

INVESTMENT FLOW
Further, it will provide greater tax certainty to the taxpayers and boost flow of investment, technology and personnel between India and

France, the statement concluded. Commenting on the development, Manoj Purohit, Partner at BDO India, said France was one of the few countries that offered exemption to a French resident on investments made in equity shares of Indian companies. The proposed amendment which is expected to tax gains without the erstwhile limit of 10 per cent will surely have some reaction from the capital market and the investor community. “Considering the kind of gains the Indian capital market has been offering over the years to its investors, the taxing of gains could have only a marginal impact, as the investor community would still look at India as its preferred investment destination,” he said. According to Abheet Sachdeva, Partner at Nangia

Global, the proposal to bifurcate dividend withholding tax under separate slabs namely, 5 per cent (where investor/ shareholder holds 10 per cent or more capital) and 15 per cent otherwise, will serve as an impetus to attract French FDI to India, and enable existing as well as potential French firms to upstream higher net-India tax profits back to the home country.

COURSE CORRECTION
Sonam Chandwani, Managing Partner at KS Legal & Associates, said the amendment to the India-France DTAC represents a decisive and overdue course correction that excises the MFN clause, a provision that had become a litigation minefield following the SC’s landmark ruling in Nestle SA (2023), where it held that MFN benefits under tax treaties do not flow automatically without a separate notification under Section 90 of the Income Tax Act. Aditya Bhattacharya, Partner, King Stubb & Kasiva, Advocates and Attorneys, said the amendment brings the treaty in line with the deletion of the MFN clause in a major clarity measure and closes the door on long-standing interpretational disputes besides reducing litigation, giving both taxpayers and the administration a more predictable framework.

With inputs from Suresh P lyengar, Mumbai

AI makes banking tech affordable for smaller institutions: Infosys Finacle CEO

bl.interview

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

As banks accelerate digital transformation amid regulatory complexity and macro uncertainty, Infosys Finacle, a digital banking solutions player, is embedding AI across its product stack. Sajit Vijayakumar, CEO, Infosys Finacle, explains how AI is reshaping their offerings, where the company sees opportunity and what the shift means for discretionary technology spending.

Excerpted excerpts:

During the Q3FY26 earnings conference call, the Infosys CEO mentioned that Finacle will be more AI-oriented. Can you elaborate?
We tell our customers that Finacle will help engage, transform, innovate and operate better — broadly, the boundaries of what a bank would do. The digital experience studio is an example of innovating and engaging better. You can roll out many customer experiences quickly and accurately. We have developed a small language model that understands Finacle’s potential defects from the past, for which there are solutions. This is like a fully trained support analyst, and more knowledgeable than any person. So, when an end-of-day job runs longer than expected, the customer can type in the issue and find out the

“We are seeing AI drive positive impact across customer interactions as well as internal product build

SAJIT VIJAYAKUMAR, CEO, Infosys Finacle



solution. This is called a SupportPro and usually has about 700 live users. One no longer has to reach out to the concerned person and can instead quickly find a solution. When transforming or upgrading Finacle from one version to another, customisations may be done by the customers, us, or anybody else. Now, an AI agent reads those customisations, understands and codifies them in a machine-understandable form, and regenerates the code in the new version. For instance, with an AI assistant, you can initiate a \$10,000 deposit with a specified maturity, and the system will auto-fill any missing data for review and submission — eliminating the need for Finacle training and potentially delivering over 50 per cent efficiency gains. We conducted a formal study with some clients in Australia, and they reported over 50 per cent gains in employee productivity driven purely by AI. You can also generate code by describing require-

ments in plain English — the agent interprets them and writes the code, which is then reviewed, tested, and validated before deployment. We are seeing AI drive positive impact across customer interactions as well as internal product build.

With AI and Cowork plugins raising concerns about disruption in software, do you see Finacle as insulated from this shift?
We are on the other side of the table. We have a fully AI-powered experience studio with 35 or so agents. Finacle has been traditionally providing software for various types of composable banking. However, each client would try to build that user journey themselves because it is core to their business. We, being a software provider, would just support them as part of a long journey. Essentially, we deploy software and they’ll design their journeys themselves. We also have an agentic experience studio where one

could make a user design externally, drop it in, and it will autonomously get converted into working code. This becomes a mobile banking app. You can build the app with all the banking capabilities with around 80 per cent efficiency. It allows banks to launch multiple-user experience journeys for different customer classes, all made possible because of GenAI advancements. We benefit substantially because the utility of the product has increased multiple times now that it is AI-embedded. We are rejoicing that AI is doing what it is doing as opposed to seeing it as a pain.

Based on your client interactions amid recent uncertainty, do you see any signs of a revival in discretionary spending?
Currently, customers are spending cautiously due to market dynamics. That being said, the whole of AI and transformation is indeed discretionary spending because then people deploy more products and expand to more markets. AI has reduced rollout costs. While an existing customer may now spend slightly less per deployment, the lower cost base is expanding the addressable market. Banks that previously could not afford such platforms, especially smaller institutions, can now adopt them. What was economically unviable five years ago has become both accessible to smaller banks and profitable for us.

Govt to partly fund compliance costs for global regulations such as CBAM, says Goyal

Our Bureau
New Delhi

To help Indian exporters meet the tightening international quality standards, the government’s export promotion mission (EPM) will fund part of the compliance costs for regulations such as the EU’s Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) and REACH, Commerce & Industry Minister Piyush Goyal has said. Producing high-quality goods and services is the only way for India to remain globally competitive, maximise the benefits of its free trade agreements (FTAs) and move towards achieving developed country status, the Minister said at a national quality conclave on Monday. As part of the EPM,



Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal

launched for five-years with a corpus of ₹22,060 crore, funds have been set aside for approval processes, wherever exporters, particularly micro and small units, require to get approvals internationally, Goyal said. “A large part of it will be funded by the government to support micro and small industries, particularly

whether it is REACH regulation of Europe... whether it’s CBAM verification to bring down your cost of carbon border adjustment mechanism tax or duty in Europe,” the Minister noted.

NEW OPPORTUNITIES
Outlining India’s trade outreach, Goyal said that nine FTAs had been finalised in the past three to three-and-a-half years with 38 developed countries, which cover nearly two-thirds of global GDP and trade. “These agreements open new opportunities in sectors such as textiles, leather, footwear and pharmaceuticals, provided Indian products consistently meet the highest global benchmarks,” he said. The Minister said that India’s current share in global trade remained modest, even

in competitive and labour-intensive sectors, and urged industry to leverage new market access opportunities created through these agreements.

5-PILLAR AGENDA
Goyal outlined a five-pillar agenda to institutionalise quality, starting with strict standard operating processes and continuous inspections from raw materials to finished goods. This strategy includes skilling the workforce to cut waste, particularly in textiles, and benchmarking against global best practices to boost competitiveness. To support this, the government will streamline certification to reduce delays and develop shared, automated testing infrastructure across manufacturing clusters.

TEXMiN inks pact with Russia’s GIREDMET on rare earth, critical minerals

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

TEXMiN Foundation (Technology Translation Research Park) has signed a strategic memorandum of understanding with Russia’s State Research and Design Institute of Rare Metal Industry (GIREDMET JSC) to focus on rare earth processing, critical minerals, advanced materials and translational research across the mining sector value chain. The purpose of the MoU is to establish a framework for strategic cooperation in the field of mining — from exploration and mineral beneficiation to extraction, separation, refining and advanced materials development.

R&D FOCUS
The collaboration will focus on joint R&D of process technologies for rare earth and critical mineral processing, as well as the development of high-purity metals and alloys, rare earth magnets, refractory metal powders, materials for electronics and optics, and

knowledge exchange across the rare metal ecosystem. TEXMiN is a Section-8 company created under the National Mission on Interdisciplinary Cyber-Physical Systems (NM-ICPS) programme by the Department of Science and Technology at IIT (ISM) Dhanbad. GIREDMET is an entity of the Rosatom State Atomic Energy Corporation of Russia, which is a nuclear energy solutions behemoth. Sukumar Mishra, Director, IIT (ISM) Dhanbad and Chairman of Hub Governing Board at TEXMiN Foundation, said, “This partnership marks an important step in strengthening global cooperation in rare metals and critical mineral technologies.” Konstantin Ivanovskikh, Deputy Director of GIREDMET, said, “This partnership marks an important step in strengthening global cooperation in rare metals and critical mineral technologies.”

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INVITING QUOTATIONS
“Quotations are invited for Renewal of Employees’ Deposit Linked Insurance (EDLI) policy for Employees / Officers of Karnataka Grameena Bank from 01.04.2026 to 31.03.2027. For further details please visit our Bank’s website <https://karnatakagb.bank.in>. Interested insurance companies may go through the tender document and submit their quotations in a sealed cover. Duly completed quotations should be submitted to the below address on or before 17.03.2026 up to 5:00 PM”.
Address: The General Manager, Human Resources Wing, Karnataka Grameena Bank, Head Office, No. 32, Sangankal Road, Gandhinagar, Ballari – 583103, Karnataka.
Sd/-
General Manager

**KiteX**
KiteX Garments Limited
(CIN: L18101KL1992PLC006528)
Regd Office: Building No. VI/496, Kizhakkambalam, Vilangu PO, Aluva, Ernakulam - 683561, Kerala
Phone: 91 484 2585000, Fax: 91 484 2680604
Email: sec@kiteksgarments.com, Website: www.kiteksgarments.com

SPECIAL WINDOW FOR TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALISATION OF PHYSICAL SHARES
In continuation to SEBI circular No. SEBI/HO/MRSD/MRSD-PoD/PI/CIR/2025/97 dated July 02, 2025, notice is hereby given to inform that in order to facilitate ease of investing for investors and to secure their rights in the securities purchased by them and to further facilitate the investors to get rightful access to their securities, SEBI vide its Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MRSD-PoD/ V3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026 has opened another special window only for transfer and dematerialisation of physical shares which were sold / purchased prior to April 01, 2019 for a period of one year from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027. The special window shall also be available for such transfer requests which were submitted earlier and were rejected/returned/not attended to due to deficiency in the documents/process/ or otherwise. During this period, securities so transferred shall be mandatorily credited to the transferee(s) in demat mode only if all the documents are found in order by the Registrar and Share Transfer (RTA) of the Company and shall be under lock-in for a period of one year from the date of registration of transfer. Such securities shall not be transferred/lien marked/pledged during the said lock-in period.
Eligible shareholders are requested to furnish necessary documents to company’s RTA viz. M/s. Cameo Corporate Services Limited at the following address: Cameo Corporate Services Limited, Subramanian Building, No.1, Club House Road, Chennai – 600 002, E-mail: investor@cameoindia.com, Phone: 044 40020731
For KiteX Garments Limited
Sd/-
Dayana Joseph
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

**Sakthi Finance**
Since 1953
SAKTHI FINANCE LIMITED
CIN : L65910TJ1955PLC000145
Regd. Office : 62, Dr.Nanjappa Road, Coimbatore - 641 018
Tel : (0422) 2231471-474, 4236200; Fax : (0422) 2231915
E-mail : investors@sakthifinance.com; Website : www.sakthifinance.com

NOTICE TO DEBENTURE HOLDERS
Redemption and Payment of Interest due on Public Issue of Secured, Redeemable, Non-Convertible Debentures issued in terms of Prospectus dated 5 April 2022 and 10 April 2023 respectively

Notice is hereby given that the Company has fixed **Wednesday, 15 April 2026** (14 April 2026, being a holiday for BSE) and **Thursday, 23 April 2026** for Options V and VI (for Public Issue 2022) and Options III and IV (for Public Issue 2023) along with interest payment, as may be applicable for the Public Issue of Secured, Redeemable, Non-Convertible Debentures (“NCDs”) of ₹ 1,000 each issued as per the Prospectus dated 5 April 2022 and 10 April 2023 respectively for determining the names of the debenture holders who are eligible to receive redemption and interest proceeds.
1. NCD PUBLIC ISSUE 2022 - ALLOTMENT DATED 29 APRIL 2022

Option	ISIN	Script Code	Interest payment frequency	Redemption details
V	INE302E07441	937981	Monthly*	100 per cent of the principal amount plus interest for the month of April 2026 (up to 28 April 2026) will be paid along with the redemption proceeds as per the terms and conditions of the Prospectus dated 5 April 2022 on 29 April 2026.
VI	INE302E07458	937983	Cumulative*	100 per cent of the principal amount plus accrued interest up to 28 April 2026 (i.e. for 4 years) will be paid along with the redemption proceeds as per the terms and conditions of the Prospectus dated 5 April 2022 on 29 April 2026.

2. NCD PUBLIC ISSUE 2023 - ALLOTMENT DATED 8 MAY 2023

Option	ISIN	Script Code	Interest payment frequency	Redemption details
III	INE302E07540	938596	Monthly*	100 per cent of the principal amount plus interest for the month of May 2026 (up to 7 May 2026) will be paid along with the redemption proceeds as per the terms and conditions of the Prospectus dated 10 April 2023 on 8 May 2026.
IV	INE302E07516	938598	Cumulative*	100 per cent of the principal amount plus accrued interest up to 7 May 2026 (i.e. for 3 years) will be paid along with the redemption proceeds as per the terms and conditions of the Prospectus dated 10 April 2023 on 8 May 2026.

*subject to deduction of tax, wherever applicable.
The Debenture Holders who have debentures in demat / electronic mode and whose names stand as the beneficial owners on the Record Dates as per the list furnished by the Depositories on **Wednesday, 15 April 2026 and Thursday, 23 April 2026** respectively, would be entitled to the redemption payments.
Debenture holders who hold debentures in electronic form are also requested to lodge mandate instructions, change in bank account details, Income Tax Exemption Certificate / forms and change of address intimation, etc. as may be applicable, with their respective Depository Participants (“DP”) on or before 3 days from the record dates i.e. 15 April 2026 and 23 April 2026 respectively.

For KiteX Garments Limited
S. Venkatesh
Company Secretary and Chief Compliance Officer
FCS 7012

For Sakthi Finance Limited
S. Venkatesh
Company Secretary and Chief Compliance Officer
FCS 7012

**COCHIN INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LIMITED**
CIAL/COML/MVT/1/2026
EOI NOTICE
FOR ENGAGEMENT OF HEALTHCARE ADVISOR SPECIALIST TO SUPPORT MEDICAL VALUE TOURISM INITIATIVE AT CIAL
Expression of Interest is invited from experienced and qualified Consultants / Agencies for associating with CIAL as Strategic Advisor for the implementation of CIAL-led Medical Value Travel (MVT) initiatives. For more details, visit www.cial.aero/tenders
Sd/-
MANAGING DIRECTOR

**THE UNITED NILGIRI TEA ESTATES COMPANY LIMITED**
(A member of the Amalgamations Group)
CIN: L01132TZ1922PLC000234
Registered Office :
No. 3, Savithri Shanmugam Road, Race Course, Coimbatore - 641 018
Phone: (0422) 2220566 / 2222865
E-mail: headoffice@unita.co.in Website: www.unitednilgiri.com

NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT/E-VOTING
Notice is hereby given to the Members of The United Nilgiri Tea Estates Company Limited (“Company”) that pursuant to the provisions of Section 108, 110 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 (“the Act”) read with Rule 20 & 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 including any statutory modification (s) or re-enactment (s) thereof for the time being in force, read with various circulars issued by MCA and SEBI, to transact the following special business by passing Ordinary Resolution by way of postal ballot through voting by electronic means (“remote e-voting”).

S. No.	Description of Ordinary Resolution
1	Re-appointment of Mr. R. Rajkumar (DIN: 10044122) as Whole-time Director of the Company for a further period of three years effective 30th March, 2026

In compliance with the MCA Circulars, the Company has completed the dispatch of Postal Ballot Notice along with the Explanatory Statement on Monday, 23rd February, 2026, by electronic means only to all its members who have registered their e-mail address with the Company, its Registrar and Share Transfer Agent or Depository / Depository Participant (s) at the close of business hours on Wednesday, 18th February, 2026 (“Cut-off date”). Once the vote on the resolution is cast by a member, he/she is not allowed to change it subsequently. The voting rights of the members shall be in proportion to their shares in the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on the cut-off date.
The communication of assent/dissent of the members will take place only by electronic means through the remote e-voting system i.e. by casting votes electronically. Accordingly, physical copy of the Notice along with Postal Ballot form and prepaid business reply envelope, have not been sent to the members for this Postal Ballot.
The Postal Ballot Notice and instructions for e-voting is available on the Company’s website at www.unitednilgiri.com. It is also available on the website of the National Stock Exchange of India Limited (“NSE”) at www.nseindia.com and on the website of National Securities Depository Limited (“NSDL”) at www.evoting.nsdl.com.
Members who have not received the notice may write to the Company Secretary at headoffice@unita.co.in and obtain the same.
The remote e-voting facility will be available during the following period:

Commencement of remote e-voting	09.00 A.M (IST) on Tuesday, February 24, 2026
Conclusion of remote e-voting	05.00 P.M. (IST) on Wednesday, March 25, 2026
Cut-off date for eligibility to vote	Wednesday, February 18, 2026

Members whose name appears on the Registrar of Members / Registrar of Beneficial Owners as maintained by the Company / Depositories as on the cut-off date will be entitled to cast their votes by remote e-voting. Also, members requested to record their assent (For) or dissent (AGAINST) only through remote e-voting by not later than 05.00 (IST) on Wednesday, March 25, 2026. The remote e-voting facility will be disabled by NSDL immediately after 05.00 P.M. (IST) on Wednesday, March 25, 2026 and no votes can be cast thereafter.
The Company has appointed Mr. S. Kasi Viswanathan, Partner, Gopalapier and Subramanian, Chartered Accountants, No.4, Guru Govind Singh Road, R.S. Puram, Coimbatore - 641002 as the Scrutinizer for conducting the Postal Ballot through remote e-voting in a fair and transparent manner.
The Scrutinizer will submit his report to the Chairman of the Company or any Director / Officer of the Company within two (2) working days from the conclusion of remote e-voting i.e. on or before Friday, March 27, 2026. Based on the Scrutinizer’s Report, the results of remote e-voting will be declared and the same shall be placed on the Company’s website at www.unitednilgiri.com and on the website of NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com and shall simultaneously be forwarded to the National Stock Exchange of India Limited (“NSE”) at www.nseindia.com where the shares of the Company are listed.
The resolution, if passed by the requisite majority, shall be deemed to have been passed on the last date specified by the Company for remote e-voting i.e. Wednesday, March 25, 2026.
In case of any queries / grievance connected with e-voting, members may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for members and e-voting user manual for members available at the download section of www.evoting.nsdl.com or call on 022-48867000 or send a request to Ms. Pallavi Mhatre, Senior Manager, NSDL at pallavi@nsdl.com.
Process for registration of email address for obtaining Postal Ballot Notice:
For Physical Shareholders – Please provide necessary details like Folio No. Name of shareholder, scanned copy of the share certificate (front and back), self-attested scanned copies of PAN and AADHAR by email to the Company at headoffice@unita.co.in or to Integrated Registry Management Services Private Limited, “Kences Towers”, 2nd Floor, No. 1, Ramakrishna Nagar, North Usman Road, T. Nagar, Chennai – 600017, Phone No: 044-28142801, Fax:044-28142479.
For Demat shareholders – Please up-date your Email ID & Mobile No. with your respective Depository Participant (DP).

By Order of the Board
For The United Nilgiri Tea Estates Company Limited
R.V. SRIDHARAN
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Place: Coimbatore
Date : 24.02.2026



A CH-CE

Intelligent summit

India should focus on AI regulation, education, skilling

The recently concluded AI summit was a signal moment in the country’s digital journey. With packed halls, global CEOs, innovators, policymakers and researchers under one roof, the event underlined India’s ambition not merely to consume Artificial Intelligence but to shape it. A key highlight was the buzz around home-grown large language models (LLMs).



Players such as Sarvam AI and BharatGen unveiled models tailored for Indian languages, governance needs and sector-specific use cases. The emphasis was clear — that India’s AI story must go beyond English-speaking urban elites and address agriculture, healthcare, education and public service delivery. If these models deliver on scale, costs and linguistic diversity, they could democratise AI in a way global platforms have not fully achieved. Equally significant was the adoption of the Delhi Declaration which is a voluntary, non-binding framework endorsed by over 88 nations. The declaration seeks to anchor AI development in shared values. In a world increasingly fractured over technology governance, even a voluntary alignment signals recognition that AI’s risks and rewards are global. Global technology leaders such as Sam Altman, Sundar Pichai and Vinod Khosla had interesting observations to make. On one hand, they suggested that AI is edging closer to systems with ‘superintelligent general intelligence’. On the other, they were candid about the disruption ahead. Jobs will change, work will be redefined and productivity gains may not translate neatly into wage growth.

For India, that warning should be the real takeaway. If AI enables companies to do more with fewer workers, or with differently skilled workers, the ripple effects on income distribution and demand could be profound. The response must begin with education. Schools and colleges need to urgently rejig curricula to prepare students for a world where humans collaborate with machines. Foundational digital literacy, critical thinking, interdisciplinary learning and ethical reasoning must move from the margins to the core. Coding alone will not suffice; understanding how to work alongside AI systems will be as crucial as building them. Industry, too, must shoulder responsibility. Companies deploying AI at scale should commit to structured workforce transitions, identifying roles at risk, mapping emerging opportunities and investing in training. The cost of transition cannot be borne solely by displaced workers.

Finally, regulation requires foresight. Allowing industry to craft its own guardrails may spur innovation in the short term. But as AI diffuses at population scale, stronger institutional frameworks will be necessary to manage risks, from bias and misinformation to systemic shocks in labour markets. The experience of social media is instructive. Policymakers globally reacted years after platforms became ubiquitous, by which time data breaches and manipulation had taken root. India must ensure not to repeat that lag.

OTHER VOICES.



The New Delhi Declaration will help fight AI colonialism
One certainty about artificial intelligence is the speed with which it has advanced in recent years — a reflection of its increasing relevance in many of our lives. Yet it would be a mistake to conflate pace with progress if the technology grows unevenly across geographies and within nations, and as long as the guardrails necessary to protect the vulnerable from potential associated threats are insufficient. It’s no longer enough to ask in what ways AI can benefit humanity, but instead how it can be made to work for everyone. The New Delhi Declaration, endorsed by 86 countries during last week’s India AI Impact Summit, represents a decisive step towards answering this question. The premise of the declaration is simple: AI must be shared equitably across humanity, and not concentrated in the hands of a few. (DUBAI, FEBRUARY 23)



Modernisation evidenced by festival’s opening-up
China’s special nine-day shopping campaign during the Spring Festival holiday has demonstrated how a society once rooted in agrarian rhythms has rewired itself for the digital age without severing its cultural roots. Consider the numbers. In just the first four days of the holiday, Hainan’s offshore duty-free sales hit 970 million yuan (\$140.51 million), up 15.8 per cent year-on-year, and average daily sales at key retail and catering enterprises nationwide rose 8.6 per cent year-on-year. Flight bookings to China surged more than 400 per cent around the holiday period. These are not merely statistics; they are signals of a society shifting from export-led growth to consumption-driven resilience. (BEIJING, FEBRUARY 23)



R KRISHNA KUMAR
As the recent AI Summit concluded, one question lingered in public discourse: Will I lose my job? While many responses from the stage were optimistic or evasive, the IMF Managing Director’s warning of significant employment disruption turns this question from casual curiosity into a legitimate concern. There are three core issues in the current ‘AI revolution’ that need serious attention. The first is job loss, the second is the major shift it brings to education, and the third is its impact on the healthcare sector. We will concentrate on the first two.
Many delegates responded to the first issue, recalling past technological shifts, such as the Industrial Revolution, the mechanisation of mills, and the computer revolution. Some mentioned retraining and predicted an increase in client-facing roles. Overall, they seemed to avoid addressing the core issue. Every technological revolution has brought both benefits and displacement. The Industrial Revolution shifted labour from agriculture to manufacturing. The transition was gradual. Mill automation displaced workers but expanding service sectors absorbed them. The computer revolution became a productivity tool, creating entirely new industries. The present AI revolution is fundamentally different. Earlier revolutions replaced physical drudgery. Generative AI tools are not merely machines; they are digital entities capable of performing reasoning, synthesis, and structured decision support. This revolution

replaces cognitive abilities. It attempts to build a powerful digital clone with superhuman abilities.

HIERARCHY OF COGNITION
Every profession has a hierarchy of cognition. Juniors use operational cognition, which encompasses algorithmic execution. As we move up the ladder, algorithmic execution is replaced by cognitive compression, the ability to compress years of knowledge into a capsule for decision-making. The AI revolution is, in fact, a form of cognitive automation capable of mastering both types of cognition. Entry-level white-collar roles across sectors are clearly vulnerable, not just computer programmers. But it is a mistake to assume senior roles are immune. AI’s ability to compress millions of documents into actionable knowledge capsules challenges even experienced professionals.
The real competition is no longer the colleague sitting next to you. It is a system with vast computational memory, continuous retraining, and no cognitive fatigue. The term “retraining” becomes ambiguous when the competitor is being retrained faster and at scale. The question one has to answer is: Can I go up the value chain faster than AI? Can I be the David in my fight with the Goliath?
The real danger for India is the possible erosion of the demographic

The pedagogical transformation required is enormous. We have to move to open-book and AI-assisted learning and examination formats, besides faculty retraining

youth bulge, especially among white-collar youth. If this segment weakens, consumption slows, investment patterns shift, and the macroeconomic impact becomes significant. Unlike previous revolutions, displaced youth today have limited alternative sectors to absorb them quickly. Large-scale manufacturing is not an alternative, as its contribution to employment is only through a trickle-down effect. Agricultural absorption is unrealistic. Informal sectors lack stability. If cognitive automation spreads faster than job creation in adjacent sectors, the demographic boon risks becoming a demographic bane.
A frequently proposed safety valve is large-scale employment as AI evaluators, auditors, or regulators. This is intellectually comforting but structurally flawed.
Meaningful evaluation requires mastery of the domain equal to or greater than that of the system being assessed. When AI continuously re-trains and aggregates global knowledge, staying consistently ahead of it becomes unrealistic for large populations. Presenting AI monitoring as a mass employment solution risks becoming another evasive reassurance rather than a credible strategy.
In sum, no level of the hierarchy is safe. It is a fallacy to claim that only junior-level programmers will be affected. Anyone who sits at a computer for their job is at risk of losing their seat.
HIGHER EDUCATION CHALLENGE
Higher education faces a disruptive challenge: what to teach, how to teach, and how to assess. When ChatGPT is banned in institutions, it often becomes the most valuable resource after graduation. This creates a clear contradiction. Our educational system

is primarily solution-based — aimed at producing correct answers from given input data within a structured system. Meanwhile, industry increasingly requires decision-making amid uncertainty, relying on strong domain expertise. AI tools are excellent at what a graduating student can do, and also have the cognitive depth to make decisions. There is a risk that a graduating student will face a massive wall, regardless of the discipline.
The pedagogical transformation required is enormous. We have to move to open-book and AI-assisted learning and examination formats, faculty retraining with the changed world in mind, shift from information delivery to decision architecture, and emphasise ethical reasoning and contextual judgment. If we do not restructure higher education, we risk graduating students trained for a world that no longer exists.
AI challenge cannot be faced with blind optimism. The solutions are not easy to find. Strengthening MSMEs, reinvigorating manufacturing, and accelerating “Make in India” initiatives may provide partial buffers. Small-scale sectors have thrived on innovations. But policy responses must move beyond slogans. AI is a double-edged sword. Its benefits in productivity, healthcare, and design are undeniable. Yet its fodder — data centres, computational scale, and rapid self-improvement — gives it unprecedented momentum ahead of humans.
We are not facing another industrial revolution. We are facing the industrialisation of cognition. That difference must serve as the basis for our policy, educational, and economic strategies.

The writer is Institute Professor, Indian Institute of Technology Madras

Data centres, GCCs powering India’s tech stack

Global enterprises rely on India teams for engineering leadership, data strategy, AI model development and cybersecurity

Sindhu Gangadharan

If there’s one shift shaping global technology conversations today, it’s the recognition that infrastructure drives innovation. AI ambitions, digital platforms, and cloud adoption all depend on strong digital foundations. Data centres have therefore moved from background enablers to strategic assets. At the same time, India’s Global Capability Centres (GCCs), continue to deepen their role in global engineering, product development, and advanced digital innovation. Together, these trends are influencing how the next generation of technology gets built, increasingly from India.
AI has raised expectations from infrastructure. Training large models, running enterprise AI workloads, enabling real-time analytics, all require sustained compute power, secure environments, and resilient connectivity. Infrastructure choices now directly influence how quickly organisations can experiment, deploy, and scale AI solutions.
According to a new Macquarie Equity Research report, India’s data centre capacity is poised for massive expansion, set to double by 2027 based on under-construction capacity and may grow fivefold by 2030 if pipeline capacity is fast-tracked. Investment activity across Bengaluru, Mumbai, Hyderabad, Pune, and NCR reflects both enterprise demand and hyper-scaler expansion.

Many GCCs are anchoring advanced engineering, AI development, cybersecurity operations, and digital platform ownership from India, naturally increasing the need for high-performance domestic infrastructure. AI workloads themselves are evolving. Generative AI, digital twins, automation platforms, and real-time analytics require specialised infrastructure such as GPU clusters, advanced cooling systems, and low-latency connectivity. These requirements are shaping the design of newer data centre facilities.

COMPUTATIONAL BACKBONE
India’s experience with population-scale digital platforms continues to influence engineering thinking, Aadhaar, UPI, and other digital public infrastructure demonstrated how reliable large-scale digital systems can operate. That exposure has created engineering confidence around scale, resilience, and performance. Data centres provide the computational backbone that allows organisations to translate that confidence into enterprise AI deployments.
India’s GCC ecosystem continues to scale in both size and strategic depth. The country now hosts over 1,700 centres employing close to two million professionals, with industry estimates from Nasscom placing the ecosystem’s value contribution at upwards of \$50 billion annually. The mix of work has also shifted steadily. A growing share of



DATA CENTRES. Provide the computational muscle for AI

new GCC investments focus on AI engineering, cloud platforms, cybersecurity, and advanced analytics rather than traditional IT or business process support. Global enterprises increasingly rely on their India teams for engineering leadership, enterprise data strategy, AI model development, and cybersecurity architecture.
Automotive companies are building connected mobility platforms, embedded software, and digital twin capabilities from India. Financial institutions are advancing AI-led risk modelling, fraud detection, and real-time analytics programmes here. Healthcare organisations are expanding data-driven research, clinical analytics, and patient insight platforms through India-based teams.
As GCC mandates expand, infrastructure requirements naturally grow alongside them. Advanced AI workloads, cybersecurity operations, and real-time analytics environments require high-performance computing

infrastructure, low latency connectivity, and strong data governance frameworks. Data centres increasingly support this layer, particularly where enterprises require proximity between engineering teams, data infrastructure, and innovation programmes.
AI sovereignty has quickly become part of mainstream technology conversations. Governments and enterprises are thinking about trusted infrastructure, secure data ecosystems and responsible AI development
India’s deep digital talent pool, expanding compute infrastructure, strong enterprise participation, and digital public infrastructure that has already operated at population scale create favourable conditions for trusted AI development. Collaboration across industry, academia, and policymakers will help ensure innovation progresses responsibly. Access to domestic compute capacity, secure data environments, and strong research ecosystems will determine how quickly India can translate its talent advantage into scalable AI innovation.
India stands as the second largest AI/ML/Data Analytics talent pool. Which also translates to the speed of translation from experimentation to enterprise deployment. Academic partnerships, startup innovation, enterprise R&D, and infrastructure create a strong innovation loop.

The writer is Chairperson, Nasscom, and MD, SAP Labs India

✉ **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Marine bio-fertilizers
This refers to ‘How sea microbes can protect agri fields’ (February 23). Marine bio-fertilizers show good market potential as they improve soil health, increase nutrient use, and reduce chemical use. Before large-scale launch, clear government guidelines are necessary. Reliable safety data, field results, and environmental approval will build buyer confidence. Farmers usually prefer the quick returns of chemical fertilizers, so awareness programmes are needed to explain

the steady and long-term benefits of microbial inputs. Hence, gradual market entry is practical. With clear policy support and monitoring, sea microbes can create a stable agri-input market and maintain farmer trust.
S Balasubramanian
Villupuram, TN
Renegotiate trade pact
Apropos ‘Tricky pitch’ (February 23), the US Supreme Court’s strike against executive overreach under the International Economic

Emergency Powers Act provides a critical strategic opening for New Delhi. While the ruling temporarily dismantles reciprocal tariffs, the administration’s pivot to Section 122 and the looming threat of Section 338 signify that protectionism is merely changing shape, not disappearing. India must avoid the reactionary impulse to walk away from existing framework deals. Instead, the current legal volatility in Washington should be leveraged to renegotiate terms from a position of relative strength. By focusing on

digital sovereignty and agricultural standards, India can transform a confused trade environment into a bilateral pact that prioritises economic pragmatism over shifting geopolitical alignments. Persistence, not retreat, remains the smartest play.
K Chidanand Kumar
Bengaluru
School education
This refers to ‘School education will change, if children were to vote’ (February 23). Voting is a democratic

S Ramakrishnasayee
Chennai



Haze over Ukraine war

Four years on, a ceasefire still seems far-fetched

Sridhar Krishnaswami

It is a date that few in the comity of nations would want to observe, certainly not Russia or Ukraine. On February 24, 2022, President Vladimir Putin ordered his tanks to roll into Ukraine in what was termed a “special military operation” in a wishful thinking that his invasion would be over in a few days and that the Ukrainians would capitulate quickly.

At the end of four years Moscow seems to be nowhere close to achieving its objectives, and the conflict has heightened European tensions, drawing in nations through American sanctions as a way of punishing Russia.

It is not as if Moscow and Kyiv are not talking but only at the nudging of President Donald Trump who has sought to employ a series of ways to get the warring parties to the table — coaxing, cajoling, threatening, and loud rhetoric.

All these seem to have impacted the neighbourhood but not so much the principals. The latest round of parleys in Geneva that included the US showed that Russia and Ukraine are still far apart. There is one thing that stands between them for a ceasefire: territory or territorial concessions.

LITTLE HEADWAY

The talks have been variously described as “difficult” and “challenging”, even “businesslike” or “not easy”. Or as one senior Russian official has been quoted: “This is complex work that requires alignment among all parties and sufficient time.” In a nutshell: Russia is demanding the Eastern Donbas that includes the regions of Donetsk and Luhansk.

That’s a definite non-starter for Ukraine; it is of the view that ceding territory means vulnerability to another attack, drawing references to the 1938 Munich Treaty that allowed Adolf Hitler to annex Sudetenland of Czechoslovakia. Further, President Volodymyr Zelensky said in a recent interview that giving up Donbas would be rejected by Ukrainians in a referendum.

For a person who believes that he is put through a lot of pressure and that it was “not fair” to be told “better come to the table, fast” by President Trump, President Zelensky is wary of giving up heavily secured and fortified areas in the east, especially in the



STUMBLING BLOCK. The demand for territorial concessions

absence of any firm security guarantees from the West. The idea that there could be a stabilisation force as a way of assuring Kyiv has also run into trouble, with Moscow bluntly saying that this European force would be fair targets.

What Kyiv is witnessing in recent weeks is a lot of chatter in capitals of Europe on ways to deter potential and possible Russian future aggression that includes testing various exotic missiles.

STATUS OF NUKE PLANT

Moscow and Kyiv would also have to address the status of the Zaporizhzhia Nuclear Power Plant that sits in the frontline and is under Russian control. Its safety has been a source of concern since it has taken hits in the bloody conflict; but nuclear inspectors who have examined the plant have vouched that there has been no radiation leaks.

In demanding its return, Ukraine has said that this power plant, Europe’s largest, can be in a Kyiv-Washington control framework, something that President Putin is unlikely to sign off easily.

For now all attention is on a ceasefire and defining the frontlines on what could be a future Ukraine that is already devoid of Crimea which Russia captured in 2014. But the bigger question is if President Putin would insist on linking the lifting of sanctions to a Ukrainian peace deal.

Complicating this is the talk of using frozen or seized Russian money for the reconstruction of Ukraine that could run into hundreds of billions of dollars. With Russia itself hurting economically, it would be wishful thinking that President Putin allows the West to keep or spend a huge pile of his money.

The writer is a senior journalist who has reported from Washington DC on North America and United Nations

Energy options after US verdict

India can use the space created by the US Supreme Court ruling to diversify oil purchases without capitulating on Russian oil

CAPITAL IDEAS.



RICHA MISHRA

After the US Supreme Court struck down President Donald Trump’s sweeping tariffs, now the debate is will India enhance buying Russian oil once again? Indian officials have been maintaining that price, supply stability and national energy security are paramount. India imports the bulk of its crude requirements and has used discounted Russian oil to manage economic pressures.

However, the purchase of Russian oil did drop. Russia was replaced by Saudi Arabia for the top supplier position looking at the numbers February 1-23. The top five suppliers to India are Saudi Arabia, Russian Federation, Iraq, United Arab Emirates and the US, currently.

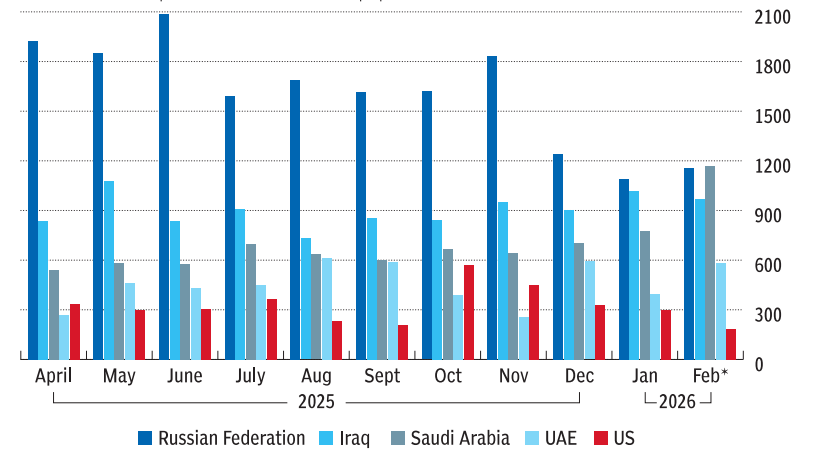
According to Prerna Prabhakar, Fellow at the Centre for Social and Economic Progress (CSEP), “India has consistently refrained from formally commenting on its purchases of Russian oil, maintaining that its energy policy is guided by national interest rather than geopolitical pressures. In this context, the recent Supreme Court ruling may reduce immediate legal pressure on India to curtail such imports.”

“However, it would be prudent to remain cautious rather than assume the matter is settled. Given the unpredictability of the Trump administration and the indication that alternative legal routes could be explored to reimpose restrictions, the situation remains fluid. A calibrated and watchful approach may therefore be more appropriate than a premature renegotiation or strategic shift,” she said.

Prabhakar has a point here — a watchful approach is what is needed. Umud Shokri, Energy Strategist and Senior Visiting Fellow at George Mason University, said: “The Supreme Court knocking down Trump’s “global tariffs” under emergency authority doesn’t magically end US pressure on countries buying Russian energy, but it does blunt



India’s top crude oil suppliers



Source: Kpler

*till Feb 22

one of the bluntest instruments Washington had been waving around.”

On pressure over Russian purchases, he said, the immediate effect is that the US loses some tariff-threat credibility as a one-step punishment tool, especially if tariffs were being used as a bargaining chip in broader trade talks. “That said,

the US still has plenty of other levers that don’t depend on that particular tariff authority: targeted sanctions, financial restrictions, shipping/insurance pressure, and “secondary sanctions” style threats,” he said.

Recent analysis has described the US using trade negotiations and tariff threats specifically to push India on Russian oil imports, and that pressure doesn’t vanish just because one legal pathway got blocked, he cautioned.

Can India turn this to its advantage? “Potentially, yes, in a very practical way: if a big chunk of “tariff leverage” is now legally constrained, India can negotiate trade terms with less fear of

The smart play for New Delhi is to honour enough of the deal to keep the relationship warm while quietly renegotiating the pieces that hurt most

The structural gaps in infrastructure finance

Saurabh Bandyopadhyay

The Union Budget has reaffirmed India’s reliance on public capital expenditure as the central pillar of its growth strategy. Public investment has expanded rapidly over the past five years. Central government capital expenditure has risen sharply in both absolute terms and as a share of GDP, marking a clear break from the fiscally constrained post-2012 period. This sustained push has helped crowd in private investment.

However, execution capacity has not scaled up at the same pace. Project monitoring data continue to show a sizeable pipeline of stalled or delayed infrastructure projects, with time overruns and cost escalations remaining widespread. Land acquisition challenges, regulatory clearances, weak project preparation and financing stress are repeatedly cited as binding constraints, particularly in highways and urban infrastructure. The divergence between rising allocations and uneven outcomes suggests that India’s infrastructure challenge is now less about spending levels and more about delivery systems.

Three structural gaps in infrastructure finance merit closer attention. First, India does not lack project announcements; it lacks bankable projects. Too often, projects

are launched before land is secured, demand risks are rigorously assessed, or revenue and risk-sharing frameworks are clearly defined. The result is predictable: delays, cost overruns and growing risk aversion among long-term investors.

A professionally managed and adequately funded project preparation framework — covering feasibility studies, environmental and social safeguards, and financial structuring — can materially improve execution quality. International experience shows that relatively small upfront investments in preparation significantly reduce downstream fiscal and contractual stress. Without this foundation, higher capital outlays risk translating into stranded assets.

NON-DEBT INSTRUMENT

Second, asset monetisation has emerged as an important non-debt financing instrument, particularly in the transport sector. Recycling capital from mature, revenue-generating assets into new infrastructure can ease fiscal pressures while sustaining investment momentum.

But credibility is key. Transparent valuation, competitive bidding, service-quality safeguards and clear ring-fencing of proceeds for fresh capital formation are essential to ensure monetisation strengthens, rather than undermines, public balance



NEEDED. Adequate project preparation

sheets. Absent these guardrails, monetisation risks being perceived as a short-term fiscal expedient rather than a durable financing strategy.

Third, despite the scale of infrastructure spending, India’s financing base remains relatively narrow. Banks and budgetary resources still dominate, while long-term domestic investors — pension funds, insurance companies and provident funds — play a limited role.

Expanding the use of long-dated, inflation-linked infrastructure bonds, strengthening pooled municipal finance mechanisms and providing regulatory clarity for institutional investment in infrastructure funds would better align financing tenors with asset lifecycles.

Recent RBI data indicate that States have increased capital expenditure as a share of GDP in recent years, reflecting a welcome shift towards growth-enhancing spending. However, aggregate improvement conceals wide

inter-State variation in fiscal space, project readiness and execution capacity. Many States continue to face weak project pipelines, limited own-source revenues and rising committed expenditures. In this context, Central support — through long-tenor, concessional loans for State capital expenditure — would yield stronger results if increasingly linked to measurable improvements in project preparation, financial reporting and user-charge frameworks.

One of the most under-emphasised aspects of India’s infrastructure strategy is operations and maintenance. Inadequate lifecycle funding leads to rapid asset deterioration, eroding economic returns and raising costs.

Climate risks compound this challenge. Floods, heat stress and extreme weather events are shortening asset lives and increasing maintenance burdens. Integrating maintenance planning, climate-resilient design standards and risk-sharing mechanisms into infrastructure finance frameworks would significantly improve value for money and protect public investment.

The challenge now is institutional: ensuring that projects are prepared better, financed smarter and maintained properly across both the Centre and the States.

The writer is Senior Fellow at NCAER, New Delhi. Views expressed are personal

thehindubusinessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

February 24, 2006

Long-distance calls turn cheaper; subsidy cut 33%

Telecom tariffs are set to take a big tumble with the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India today announcing reduced access deficit charges. The decrease in the total subsidy amount, which is used to fund rural telephony, will enable all telecom operators to lower STD rates to ₹1 a minute from the present average tariff of ₹2.50 a minute.

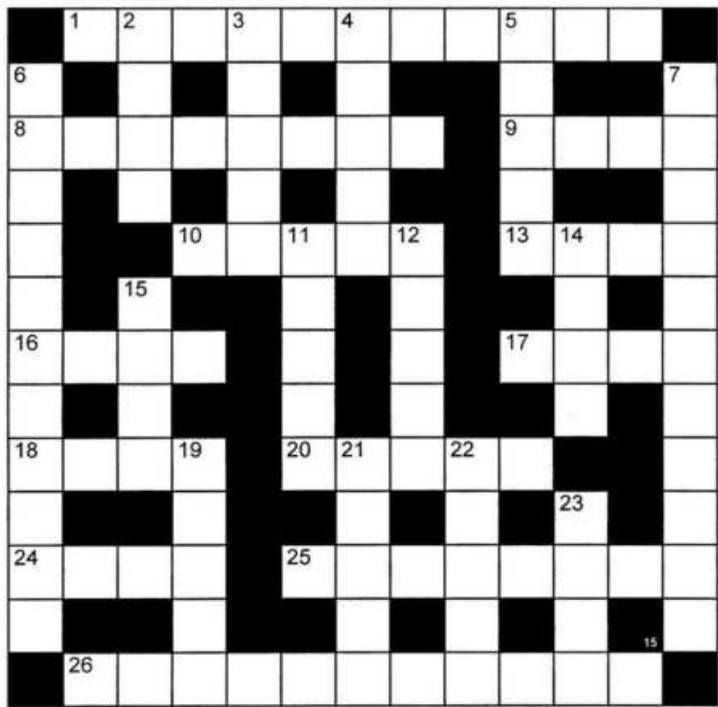
IPO scam: Transit remand for accused

The four key accused in the Initial Public Offer (IPO) scam have surrendered before the CBI and will be produced in the special CBI Court in Mumbai on Friday. The CBI has been granted transit remand of the four — Deepak Panchal, Jayesh Khandwalla, Parag Zhaveri and Dhirendra Vora.

Tatas interested in nuclear power

The Tata Group will be interested in getting into nuclear power as and when the Government permits the domestic private sector into this field, according to Mr Ratan Tata, Chairman, Tata Sons. At the same time, Mr Tata believes that the country’s power strategy should be coal-based, adopting new coal technologies to control air pollution.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2623



EASY

ACROSS

- Headlong, without deliberation (11)
- Contrivance, trickery (8)
- Brought into the world (4)
- Privately, apart (5)
- Labyrinth (4)
- Not fat (4)
- Gratis (4)
- Flat-bottomed river craft (4)
- Brewing, baking agent (5)
- Notion (4)
- Loud, harsh (8)
- At _____: at issue, quarrelling (11)

DOWN

- Duty list (4)
- Turned-back sleeve ends (5)
- Given running rate (5)
- Blank-leaf book (5)
- One suffering irresistible drowsiness (11)
- Forerunners, ancestors (11)
- Seeming fate-mocked condition (5)
- Something in addition (5)
- Sprightly, off-handed (4)
- Chess front-piece (4)
- Sound of plucked string (5)
- Put name down for (5)
- County, rural district (5)
- Make one’s way (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- Make it rain and hurl oneself headlong into action (11)
- Bit of trickery seen if one is put in wrong crate (8)
- Brought into existence by old boy backing the Navy (4)
- Privately, 24s may be revised (5)
- Complicated system of extracting one from the corn (4)
- Be inclined to have little flesh on one’s bones (4)
- Is not tied up for nothing (4)
- Back a horse one can move with a pole (4)
- It leavens, and is easy to mix on tabletop (5)
- Thought one to be almost deaf (4)
- Loud, grating way it sent dirt packing (8)
- At such, is quarrelling about George’s lad gulping hydrogen (11)

DOWN

- Duty cycle that originally turns up in part (4)
- Blow the ends of one’s sleeves (5)
- Regulated rate at which one walked up and down (5)
- Record may have something in it, book perhaps not (5)
- He keeps dropping off in order to conceal trip (11)
- Can’t see dent formed by previous history (11)
- Satirical form of one right, only left out (5)
- There’s more to him than playing in a crowd (5)
- Jaunty pen lost her head (4)
- Take a chess piece to uncle (4)
- Nasal tone gnat makes flying up round top of window (5)
- Come on stage of National Theatre ere it’s changed (5)
- She is about to put one right in the county (5)
- Make one’s way to the West End (4)

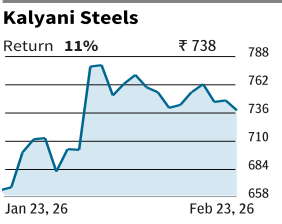
SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2622

ACROSS 1. Somebody 4. Oval 8. Col 9. Drake 10. Run 11. Larceny 12. Elide 13. Prosecution 17. Rinse 18. Debauch 20. Ado 21. Sauce 22. All 23. Tone 24. Pediment

DOWN 1. Sockly 2. Molar 3. Diary 5. Vertigo 6. Lender 7. Detestable 9. Dress sense 14. Rundown 15. Truant 16. Pellet 18. Drupe 19. Crave

QUICKLY.

Kalyani Steels, 2 others settle SEBI violation case



New Delhi: Three entities, including Kalyani Steels (KSL), on Monday settled a case with SEBI over the alleged violation of disclosure and related-party transaction norms after paying ₹4.12 crore collectively. The order came after the applicants (Kalyani Steels, BF Utilities and Deepti R Puranik) proposed to settle the instant proceedings initiated against them, “without admitting or denying the findings of fact and conclusions of law”. SEBI examined financial transactions of the Kalyani group of companies, following a report from NSE dated March 20, 2023, which flagged possible lapses in investments made by group entities. **■**

InvITs distribute ₹5,565 cr in Q3 FY26 to unitholders

Mumbai: India's listed Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs) paid out ₹5,565 crore to approximately four lakh unitholders in the third quarter of FY26, according to data released on Monday by the Bharat InvITs Association. Two new InvITs began making distributions during the quarter, adding to the sector's expansion. Since inception, InvITs have cumulatively distributed ₹83,770 crore to investors, cementing their position as a significant vehicle for monetising infrastructure assets in India. Total assets under management across listed InvITs now stand at ₹7 lakh crore, spread across roads, transmission, renewable energy and infrastructure segments. **OUR BUREAU**

Jefferies flags AI risks, downgrades 6 stocks

Our Bureau

Bengaluru

IT stocks have turned increasingly volatile in recent sessions, as investors reassess the sector's prospects amid growing concerns over AI-driven disruption, pricing pressure in core services and stretched valuations.

The sell-off continued on Monday, with tech stocks dragging the Nifty IT index down 1.4 per cent — nearly 2 per cent at one point intra-day — after Jefferies issued cautious commentary on the sector's outlook.

The global investment advisory firm has turned more circumspect on India's IT services space, warning that artificial intelligence could structurally alter business models and compress valuations, even as the sector has seen a rebound this year.

In a note titled “P(AI)n Not Over Yet; Stay Selective,” it cut EPS estimates for its coverage universe by 1-4 per cent and slashed price

SEBI to study brokers’ plea on RBI diktat

ON THE AGENDA. Will undertake comprehensive review of portfolio manager regulations, says Chairman

Akshata Gorde

Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) will examine representations made by stockbrokers on the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) revised bank funding and collateral norms, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said on Monday.

“We have received a representation, including from ANMI. We have seen it and we will examine it,” Pandey said at a portfolio management services (PMS) industry conclave.

He said the RBI had earlier issued draft guidelines and followed a consultative process before notifying the final framework.

“There are three or four issues. It is basically a matter with the RBI. But since the representation has also come to us, we will have a look at it,” he said.

However, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said on Monday that RBI is not planning to revisit the announced rules for bank financing of proprietary traders and brokers. He said the central bank had already watered down the proposal as the original draft norms had proposed a complete ban on such lending.

BROKER CONCERNS

The Association of National Exchanges Members of India (ANMI) recently made representations to SEBI, raising concerns over the RBI's tightened norms governing bank guarantees and cash collateral for capital market intermediaries. The industry body has flagged potential operational and funding challenges for brokers once the revised framework comes into effect.

SEBI also plans to undertake a comprehensive review of the SEBI (Portfolio Man-



KEY CONCERNS. There are three or four issues. It is basically a matter with the RBI. But since the representation has also come to us, we will have a look at it, said SEBI chief Tuhin K Pandey

agers) Regulations, 2020, to align it to the evolved market. “We propose to carry out a comprehensive review of the PMS regulations so that the framework remains robust and relevant. However, regulation alone cannot build a strong industry,” Pandey said.

The regulator has already begun working on rational-

isation of settlement regulations, takeover norms, and listing obligations and disclosure requirements (LODR), which could be taken to the board by June, he said.

“Risk profiling, suitability assessment, and client communication must be clear, consistent and evidence-based. Going ahead, PMS

distributor conduct will matter — the industry must guard against mis-selling,” Pandey said.

AUM SURGE

The PMS industry had around 2,15,000 clients as of January, with assets under management, excluding those under EPFO and PF, of about ₹10.5 lakh crore, growing at a compound annual growth rate of 17 per cent.

Meanwhile, total clients, as of January 31, stood at about 2.15 lakh — an almost 50 per cent increase from 2022. The number of registered portfolio managers also increased from 361 to 501 over the same period.

Pandey also referred to the importance of internal controls and accountability within the regulator. This comes amid reports that SEBI suspended its General Manager Achal Singh on Friday on alleged issues of integrity.

US Supreme Court tariff ruling lifts Sensex, Nifty

Our Bureau

Mumbai

Benchmarks closed higher on Monday after the US Supreme Court struck down President Donald Trump's reciprocal tariff framework, though fresh 15 per cent import tariffs announced under executive powers kept markets on edge.

The Sensex gained 479.95 points to close at 83,294.66, while the Nifty rose 141.75 points to settle at 25,713.

The rally, however, was tempered. Markets opened with an upside gap, the Nifty hitting an intraday high of 25,771, before profit booking pulled it lower as traders digested the announcement of a flat 15 per cent import tariff that Trump retained under executive powers.

Sectorally, PSU Banks were the standout performers, with the index rising 1.35 per cent. Pharma,

oil & gas, infrastructure, FMCG and auto sectors posted gains of around 0.5 per cent each.

On the losing side, the IT index shed over 1.5 per cent, its fourth consecutive session of decline, on concerns over AI-led disruption and global uncertainty. Metals fell 0.2 per cent.

Among Nifty 50 top gainers, Adani Ports led with a 2.81 per cent, followed by Kotak Bank up 2.24 per cent. HDFC Life gained 1.97 per cent, Dr Reddy's rose 1.93 per cent and UltraTech Cement added 1.60 per cent.

However, Hindalco fell 2.23 per cent, Wipro shed 1.89 per cent, Infosys dropped 1.86 per cent, Tech Mahindra declined 1.35 per cent and Cipla lost 1.05 per cent. Broader markets were mixed. The Nifty Midcap 100 slipped 0.43 per cent, while the Nifty Smallcap 100 edged up 0.29 per cent. The Nifty Next 50 gained 0.39 per cent.

PNGS Reva’s IPO opens today, raises ₹171 crore from anchor investors

Amit Vijay Mohile

Mumbai

PNGS Reva Diamond Jewellery's ₹380-crore IPO, opening February 24-26, will test whether a strong Maharashtra franchise can translate into a scalable national diamond jewellery brand.

The performance, however, remains geographically concentrated. Between FY23 and H1 FY26, nearly 97 per cent of revenue came from Maharashtra. While the State helped build the brand, such reliance leaves Reva exposed to regional demand swings and intensifying competition from national

chains such as Tanishq and Kalyan Jewellers.

Chief executive Amit Modak told *businessline* that around 60 per cent of the 15 new stores planned from the IPO will remain in Maharashtra, with the rest spread across northern States. Of the ₹380 crore issue, ₹286.5 crore will fund store expansion and ₹35.4 crore marketing and brand-building.

Reva marks the group's sharper pivot toward studied diamond jewellery, as consumers shift from plain gold to lighter, design-focused pieces amid elevated gold prices.

Ahead of the issue, the company raised ₹170.58

crore from anchor investors. Demerged from PN Gadgil & Sons in January 2025, Reva reported FY25 revenue of ₹258.2 crore, up 32 per cent y-o-y, while net profit rose 40 percent to ₹59.5 crore.

At the upper end of the ₹367-386 price band, the IPO values Reva at about ₹1,224 crore, implying roughly 21 times FY25 earnings, positioning it between lower-multiple regional players and higher-valued national chains.

Early signs suggest expansion may pressure profitability. In H1 FY26, revenue rose to ₹156.7 crore across 34 stores, but margins narrowed to 12.8 per cent.

MF industry AUM hits 32% of bank deposits

Suresh P Iyengar

Mumbai

The assets under management (AUM) of the mutual fund industry hit 32 per cent of the overall bank deposits in January on the back of a relentless SIP campaign and the banks themselves turning out to be one of the biggest distributors of MF products.

The average MF assets, as of January-end, were at ₹82 lakh crore, accounting for 32 per cent of bank deposits at ₹254 lakh crore.

RETAIL INFLOWS

In January 2025, the average AUM of MFs at ₹68 lakh crore accounted for 30 per

cent of bank deposits at ₹226 lakh crore.

The assets of MFs have been growing much faster than bank deposits, as retail investors poured into equity market through SIP, which touched a record high of ₹32,000 crore last month.

The deposit with banks has increased 12 per cent to ₹254 lakh crore as of January against ₹226 lakh crore logged in the same period last year.

In the same period, the MF assets registered growth of 20 per cent in the last month to ₹82 lakh crore against ₹68 lakh crore.

INVESTOR GROWTH

Unique investors count of the MF industry increased



13 per cent last month to 6.02 crore.

The aggregate NFO flows in last one year were at ₹65,100 crore, of which equity funds comprised 61 per cent or ₹39,433 crore.

Shweta Rajani, Mutual Fund Head, Anand Rathii Wealth, said over the past 10 years, the MF AUM to bank deposit ratio had increased

significantly from 11 per cent in FY16 to the current level, as mutual funds are increasingly becoming a core savings vehicle. “We are not expecting moderation in flows, as SIP inflows continue to register consistent M-o-M growth despite market volatility and muted returns,” she said.

Shashank Udupa, Fund Manager, smallcase, said SIPs have become a habit for retail investors and are treated like monthly savings commitments rather than tactical equity bets.

Lower markets investors to accumulate more units at cheaper valuations and many long-term investors actually view this as an opportunity, he said.

BROKER'S CALL.

Motilal Oswal

LENSKART SOLUTIONS (BUY)

Target: ₹600

CMP: ₹486.55

Lenskart is India's largest vertically integrated, technology-led, omnichannel eyewear platform, addressing a structurally underpenetrated eyewear category in India (53 per cent of the population impacted, modest about 35 per cent penetration). We expect Lenskart to deliver a CAGR of 25/53 per cent in pro forma consolidated revenue/pre-IND AS EBITDA, largely driven by volume growth, product margin improvement, and around 625 bps operating leverage-driven margin expansion over FY25-28 (about 320 bps over 9MFY26-FY28).

Lenskart's near-term FCF generation is impeded by upfront capex on the upcoming Hyderabad facility (to future-proof the business). However, we expect significant improvement in FCF generation (to around 65-70 per cent of pre-IND AS EBITDA) beyond FY28. We initiate coverage on Lenskart with a BUY rating and a TP of ₹600, premised on DCF-implied 55x FY28E pre-INDAS EBITDA. Our valuations for Lenskart are at a premium to other leading retailers, but we believe the multiples are justifiable, given Lenskart's superior growth profile, limited organised competition and long growth runway.

Key risks: Significant dependence on China for import of raw material; high concentration of manufacturing operations in North India; Loss-making overseas subsidiaries dilute overall profitability; and shortage of trained optometrists.

JM Financial

APL APOLLO TUBES (ADD)

Target: ₹2,475

CMP: ₹2,191.55

APL Apollo Tubes (APAT), leader in the structural tubes market, is doubling capacity to 10mt by FY30E and pivoting towards value-added segments. This shift is powered by relentless innovation and portfolio reinvention while maintaining 5,000+ SKUs — a move that seeks to balance premium positioning with mass-market reach.

These efforts are also culminating in structural moats that reinforce returns, with scale of sourcing and distribution strength driving sustained pricing power and superior capital efficiency. The company has demonstrated strong working capital discipline, with the adoption of a cash-and-carry model in 2020 structurally reducing receivable days and specialisation by plant improving inventory turns. APAT remains a net-cash company with incremental capex to be funded via internal accruals, ensuring no strain on the balance sheet and supporting a strong returns profile. All in all, we are initiating coverage at Add with a TP ₹2,475 based on 36x Mar'28E EPS (in line with last five-year average).

We model in an EBITDA CAGR of over 20 per cent over FY26-28E (largely mirroring its historical growth trajectory), aided by operating leverage and cost efficiencies. Improving profitability and a strong net cash balance sheet shall keep return ratios at above 25 per cent over coming years. The stock has run up over 30 per cent over the past six months. Key risks include volatility in HRC prices, heightened competitive intensity and economic slowdown.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

ICICI Prudential Life (₹663.50): BUY

Gurumurthy K

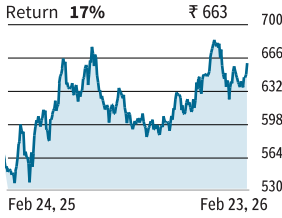
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for ICICI Prudential Life Insurance Company (LIC). The stock has been getting very good support from its 200-Day Moving Average (DMA) since late January this year.

The recent bounce is also happening from the 200-DMA support which is currently at ₹630. Immediate resistance is at ₹670. The stock can break this resistance. Such a break can take ICICI Prudential LIC share price higher to ₹705-710 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy ICICI Prudential LIC shares now at ₹663.

Accumulate on dips at ₹648. Keep the stop-loss at ₹628

ICICI Prudential Life



initially. Revise the stop-loss up to ₹672 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹680.

Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹678 and ₹686 when the price touches ₹684 and ₹692 respectively. Exit the longs at ₹705.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

25701 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
25580	25370	25780	25900	Go long on a break above 25780 with a stop-loss at 25730	

₹924 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
920	917	930	936	Go long only above 930. Stop-loss can be placed at 928	

₹1328 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1315	1280	1340	1360	Take fresh shorts below 1315. Keep the stop-loss at 1325	

₹326 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
322	318	328	335	Go long only above 328. Stop-loss can be kept at 326	

₹276 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
271	266	280	283	Go long on dips at 274 and 272 with a stop-loss at 270	

₹1426 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1415	1400	1445	1465	Take fresh longs above 1445. Keep the stop-loss at 1440	

₹1229 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1220	1205	1235	1260	Go long only above 1235. Stop-loss can be kept at 1230	

₹2675 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2645	2590	2700	2755	Go long on a break above 2700. Keep the stop-loss at 2680	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN%	
HDFC Bank	923.60	39.42	18.35	12.05	
Kotak Bank	430.70	15.08	22.79	8.70	
Reliance Ind	1428.90	12.74	19.76	2.22	
Bharti Airtel	1997.30	12.16	30.74	4.75	
Axis Bank	1386.70	11.57	16.30	3.39	
State Bank	1227.80	10.65	13.10	4.35	
L&T	4418.10	9.66	32.03	4.43	
ICICI Bank	1399.40	7.68	17.68	8.53	
Adani Ports	1555.80	7.17	28.68	2.98	
M&M	3447.10	6.72	25.26	0.82	
Hind Unilever	2345.40	6.01	54.81	1.78	
UltraTech Cement	12976.00	5.46	49.90	1.31	
PowerGrid Corp	303.35	4.37	18.17	1.17	
Dr Reddys Lab	1307.40	3.61	19.76	0.80	
Greiner India	2873.40	3.40	20.65	0.94	
Nestle India	1315.10	3.35	77.75	0.68	
Titan	4272.70	3.29	79.59	1.50	
HDFC Life	742.45	3.25	84.61	1.68	
Eicher Motors	8038.50	3.08	41.16	0.94	
SBI Life	2109.60	2.91	86.23	0.81	
Maruti Suzuki	15972.00	2.73	31.74	1.39	
NTPC	375.45	2.60	14.66	1.52	
Bajaj Auto	9905.50	2.40	31.14	0.94	
TataConsumerProduct	1171.80	2.23	78.80	0.65	
Sun Pharma	1732.30	1.83	37.95	1.56	
Apollo Hosp	7693.00	1.75	59.28	0.68	
Adani Enter.	1717.30	1.71	74.27	0.69	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1064.70	1.66	21.90	1.27	
Coal India	426.00	1.22	8.82	0.83	
JSW Steel	1240.50	0.97	39.06	0.99	
Tata Motors PV	379.95	0.89	51.67	0.68	
Bajaj Finance	1031.00	0.47	35.01	2.34	
Int'l Chemicals	4862.20	0.38	58.54	0.94	
Asian Paints	2429.70	0.16	59.60	0.94	
Quality Walls	26.95	-0.15	0.00	0.02	
Tata Steel	287.14	-0.40	28.49	1.47	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	251.80	-0.58	102.06	0.72	
Nas Healthcare	1083.60	-0.52	74.27	0.69	
Bajaj Finserv	2051.60	-0.87	17.07	1.00	
Bharat Elec	439.75	-1.10	53.91	1.34	
Trent Ltd.	4054.90	-1.76	88.99	0.77	
Cipla	1326.50	-1.80	23.64	0.64	
TCS	2676.30	-2.22	20.19	2.33	
Tech Mahindra	1440.90	-2.20	30.75	0.78	
Eternal Ltd.	268.00	-2.28	119.61	1.64	
HCL Tech	1426.20	-2.38	23.50	1.28	
Wipro	205.89	-2.49	16.19	0.50	
ONGC	275.65	-2.56	7.71	0.91	
ITC	321.40	-3.38	19.69	2.67	
Hindalco	916.20	-6.18	12.81	1.13	
Infosys	1327.50	-19.74	19.22	3.97	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

▲ 269.45 pts.

	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN%
Bajaj Holdings	11501.00	40.66	14.28	2.14
Bpcl	372.10	33.73	6.56	3.10
United Spirits	1416.90	33.32	59.92	1.80
Indian Oilcorp	176.46	29.93	6	2.94
Cholamandlamin&Fin	1689.80	25.63	29.42	3.08
Siemens	302.20	25.46	74.17	1.26
Bank Of Baroda	313.35	23.93	8.25	2.50
Canara Bank	156.44	23.16	7.71	2.27
Torrent Pharma	4307.60	20.68	64.17	1.94
Cosmos Consumer	176.46	20.52	68.69	2.12
Samarvadhotomessinternatnl	130.82	18.66	37.94	2.50
Gp Power & Ind Sol	720.50	17.20	102.27	2.13
Adani Power	144.05	15.98	24.59	2.45
Pidlitind	1481.00	15.00	60.51	1.68
Vardhagenergies	141.70	14.17	50.53	1.99
ICI Lombard Cyg	1953.80	12.65	24.72	2.04
Siemens Energy India	2815.70	10.91	88.51	2.08
Tvs Motor Comp	3829.10	9.09	59.57	3.87
Britannia Ind	6122.50	8.49	61.03	3.11
Power Finance	411.80	7.43	40.7	2.58
Punjab Natl Bank	130.27	7.03	8.38	1.93
Lt	883.25	6.63	10.93	0.84
Tata Power	379.25	6.30	24.20	2.74
Ambuja Cements	5153.30	6.04	25.88	1.35
Adani Energy Solutions	1003.80	5.93	50.59	1.50
Solar Industries	13370.00	5.41	79.25	4.00
Zyduslifesciences	987.95	5.41	18.18	0.98
Bosch	35340.00	3.25	37.81	1.32
Hindus Zinc	590.85	1.95	21.15	1.10
Adanigenenergy	970.35	1.93	86.12	1.28
Sree Cement	26550.00	1.60	53.33	1.63
Shree Cement Developers	104.25	1.48	32.03	1.35
Divis Lab	623.93	0.95	67.40	3.44
Indian Hotels Co	675.10	0.40	44.40	2.55
Indian Railway Finance Corp	111.89	0.05	20.87	0.86
Havells	1412.80	-0.08	59.76	1.53
Jindal Steel	1216.60	-0.56	61.56	1.96
Shree Cement	104.25	-2.28	29.34	2.88
Hyundai Motor India	628.80	-3.68	32.06	4.00
Dlf	226.30	-5.77	30.51	1.73
Info Edge I	1069.70	-5.94	41.16	1.79
Vedanta	681.25	-6.11	16.08	4.97
Rural Elec	352.70	-7.49	5.38	1.89
3ienergy	30.90	-9.32	87.36	2.44
Gail (India)	161.73	-10.84	12.77	1.94
Abb India	5917.50	-10.04	74.36	3.14
Jsw Energy	486.40	-12.15	32.65	1.12
Ltmitrendre	4831.50	-16.14	30.32	1.75
Shree Cement	104.25	-18.10	38.23	0.75
Hindustanaromatics	4022.40	-82.31	30.26	3.29

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

SC seeks Centre's reply on NCR's air quality proposal

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Monday sought responses of Union Ministries on a proposal to shift all coal-based industries out of Delhi-NCR and not allow new units to be set up to ensure better air quality. A Bench, comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joyymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi, directed Uttar Pradesh, Haryana and Rajasthan to call for feedback from stakeholders, including coal-based industries in the NCR, on the proposal.

Kerala appoints 12th Pay Revision Commission

Kochi: The Kerala government has issued orders appointing the 12th Pay Revision Commission, headed by former Chief Secretary VP Joy, to recommend revised pay for government employees. Advocate M Rajagopalan Nair and retired Additional Secretary Sreelatha Sukumaran have been appointed members. VR Shobha, Additional Secretary, Finance, will act as the Secretary.

UP, Rajasthan and AP lead in EV, green hydrogen adoption: Study

FRONT RUNNERS. States' Electricity Transition report analysed 21 States representing 95% of power demand

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

To increase the adoption of electric vehicles (EVs) and green hydrogen fuel, States such as Uttar Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh and Rajasthan undertook regulatory steps including green tariffs, green open access mechanism, and made progress on solar-hour-aligned time-of-day (ToD) tariffs.

The States' Electricity Transition (SET) report, a joint study by the Institute for Energy Economics and Financial Analysis (IEEFA) and Ember, analysed 21 States, which represent 95 per cent of India's power demand.

Karnataka, Himachal Pradesh and Kerala have also progressed well in decarbonising their electricity systems with higher renewable energy (RE) share in their procurement mix and lower



NORTHERN STARS. Delhi and Haryana remain ahead in terms of power ecosystem readiness and performance

power sector emissions intensity.

Similarly, Delhi and Haryana remain ahead in terms of power ecosystem readiness and performance, supported by robust distributed solar adoption, reliable power supply, and relatively sound discom performance.

AHEAD OF THE PACK
Uttar Pradesh demonstrated

strong momentum in EV deployment, the study noted, with an adoption rate of 10 per cent in FY25. It has a RE policy, which targets 22 GW of solar capacity installed by FY27.

The State's green tariff premium for FY26, at \$0.0041 per kWh (₹0.34/kWh), reflects a reduction compared to the previous year. Uttar Pradesh is also

advancing in green hydrogen uptake and has a target of 1 million tonnes by 2028. It has also introduced a solar-hour-aligned ToD tariff mechanism. The State could benefit from accelerating its efforts to install storage capacity to facilitate reliability of RE sources.

AP & SMART METERS

On the other hand, Andhra Pradesh's performance is driven by its integrated RE policy released in October 2024 and advancements in green hydrogen uptake.

With the deployment of smart meters, Andhra Pradesh is actively moving towards implementing the solar-hour-aligned ToD tariff mechanism. It has adopted the Green Energy Open Access Rules, 2022, with limited waivers on open access charges such as cross subsidy surcharge, State distribution and transmission charges.

Andhra Pradesh's latest

green tariff premium stands at \$0.0083 per kWh (₹0.75 per kWh). The State has 1,440 MW of pumped hydro storage capacity operational or under construction. It performed moderately in EV ecosystem development with a 6.2 per cent adoption rate in FY25 across all vehicle categories.

Building on its RE leadership, Rajasthan continued to excel with a well-established RE policy landscape and with the lowest green tariff premium of \$0.0006 per kWh (₹0.05/kWh).

It performed moderately in transport sector decarbonisation, with an EV adoption rate of 6.6 per cent in FY25. However, despite advancing in ToD tariff mechanism adoption, Rajasthan fell behind in the deployment of smart meters.

The State only has 25 MW of storage capacity, indicating significant scope to expand its storage capacity.

LS Speaker forms teams of MPs to interact with peers of 64 nations to boost ties

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi



Om Birla, Lok Sabha Speaker

Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla on Monday constituted "Parliamentary Friendship Groups" with members from the ruling and opposition parties to strengthen ties with 64 countries, including the US, the UK, France and Australia.

"The move reflects a conscious effort by the Indian Parliament to deepen dialogue and exchanges with legislatures across continents and to complement traditional diplomacy with sustained parliamentary interaction," a statement by the Lok Sabha Secretariat said.

Building upon the Prime Minister's multi-party outreach following Operation Sindoor, when teams of Members of Parliament teams went to various countries to convey India's point of view, the Lok Sabha Speaker provided a formal institutional framework to the Parliamentary Friendship Groups, the statement added.

GROUP LEADERS

The group for the US will be led by Baijayant Panda (BJP), while Bhartuhari Mahtab (BJP) will lead the group for the UK.

Shashi Tharoor (Congress) has been assigned to head the group for France. Similarly, SP chief Akhilesh Yadav will lead the team for Australia.

For various other countries, Ravi Shankar Prasad, M Thambidurai (AIADMK), P Chidambaram (Congress), Ram Gopal Yadav (SP), TR Baalu (DMK), Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar (Trinamool Congress), Gaurav Gogoi (Congress), Kanimozhi Karunanidhi (DMK), Abhishek Banerjee (Trinamool Con-

gress), Asaduddin Owaisi (AIMIM), Sanjay Singh (AAP), and Praful Patel (NCP-Ajit Pawar), among others, will lead the groups.

Some of the countries for which such Parliamentary Friendship Groups have been constituted include Sri Lanka, Germany, New Zealand, Switzerland, South Africa, Bhutan, Saudi, Israel, Maldives, Russia, EU Parliament, South Korea, Nepal, Japan, Italy, Oman, Greece, Singapore, Brazil, Vietnam, Mexico, Iran and UAE.

EXPERIENCE SHARING

According to the statement, the idea behind the initiative is to allow lawmakers to speak directly to their overseas counterparts, share legislative experience, and build trust through regular engagement and exchange best practices to further strengthen bilateral relations and promote greater mutual understanding.

Beyond parliamentary procedure, the groups are expected to facilitate conversations on trade, technology, social policy, culture, and global challenges that democracies face today.

Post-Operation Sindoor, Prime Minister Narendra Modi took the initiative to send multi-party delegations to various countries to convey India's point of view.

Govt to auto credit ₹30.52 cr in 7.11 lakh inoperative EPFO accounts

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

The Ministry of Labour and Employment has decided to auto credit ₹30.52 crore lying in 7.11 lakh inoperative Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) accounts, holding ₹1,000 or less, to subscribers.

The refund will not require any documentation, except bank verification to confirm that the beneficiary's or nominee's account is Aadhaar-seeded and functional, said top Ministry

sources. An EPF account is declared inoperative if it does not see any contribution for 36 months at a stretch.

PILOT PROJECT

On Monday, Minister for Labour and Employment Mansukh Mandaviya gave nod for a pilot project to auto credit EPF money in 7.11 lakh out of the total 31.86 lakh inoperative accounts, each of which has a balance of ₹1,000 or less, said sources.

In total, ₹10,903 crore is lying idle in 31.86 lakh inoperative accounts, opened

over the last two decades.

If the Ministry's pilot project is successful, the initiative will expand to the remaining 24.76 lakh subscribers, who have larger amounts held in their accounts, added sources.

EPF can be withdrawn after retirement at the age of 58 or after permanent disability or post two months of unemployment.

Partial withdrawals, however, are permitted for specific needs like medical emergencies, marriage, education or home construction/loan repayment. As per



the Ministry's written response to queries in Parliament, the total amount in the inoperative EPF account had spiralled over five-fold to ₹8,505.23 crore in FY24, from ₹1,638.37 crore in

FY19. Over 1.32 crore accounts had zero closing balance for FY24.

OTHER INITIATIVES

In another initiative, the Ministry has undertaken a significant pro-labour reform to strengthen educational support for the children of eligible unorganised workers.

The Ministry amended the relevant provision of Labour Welfare Scheme (Education Component). This allows a student from the unorganised sector, availing the Ministry's welfare-based schol-

arship, to receive a merit-based scholarship from any Central or State government agency.

This reform marks a departure from the earlier provision and ensures that deserving students from unorganised worker families are not denied educational opportunities due to overlapping eligibility conditions, said Ministry sources.

The measure is expected to directly benefit the wards of such unorganised workers by improving access to higher education and reducing dropout rates.

Sonowal lays foundation stone, opens ₹1,500-crore projects at VOC Port

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Union Minister of Ports, Shipping & Waterways, Sarbananda Sonowal, on Monday laid foundation stones and inaugurated projects totalling over ₹1,500 crore at the VO Chidambaranar Port in Thoothukudi.

The projects spanned upgraded rail and road connectivity, enhanced power infrastructure, renewable energy integration (including solar, wind, battery storage, and green hydrogen production), advanced safety systems, and digital platforms.

These projects will improve cargo evacuation efficiency, shorten vessel turnaround times, strengthen multimodal logistics, and elevate operational safety,



Sarbananda Sonowal, Union Minister of Ports, Shipping & Waterways

the VOC Port Authority said in a statement.

The projects will extend benefits far beyond the port, lowering logistics costs for trade, spurring industrial expansion—including shipbuilding and manufacturing—in Thoothukudi, Tirunelveli, and Madurai

districts, attracting investment, creating employment, and stimulating sectors such as renewable energy, logistics, and tourism.

INITIATIVES

The Maritime Heritage Museum inaugurated today will enrich the socio-economic fabric of southern Tamil Nadu. The minister said that the VOC Port is undertaking transformative initiatives — from shipbuilding and the Outer Harbour Project to wide-ranging green measures — that will redefine the economic landscape of the entire region.

These efforts will strengthen its position as a major transshipment hub, enabling it to compete with and, in time, surpass Colombo and other leading regional ports.

As HAL shares take a hit after reports of 'another LCA Tejas accident', PSU says it is 'minor tech glitch'

Our Bureau
New Delhi

With Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd (HAL) suffering a blow at the stock exchange following news reports of 'third LCA Tejas aircraft accident', the leading maharatna defence PSU clarified on Monday that the indigenous fighter jet was involved only in a "minor technical incident", which is being probed jointly with the Indian Air Force.

The defence PSU clarified on Monday that the fighter jet had a "minor technical incident", which it is probing along with the Indian Air Force (IAF).

'NO CRASH'

In a stock exchange filing, the government-owned company said, "There has been no reported crash of the LCA Tejas."



A file photo of IAF's light combat aircraft Tejas

HAL added, "The event in question was a minor technical incident on the ground. LCA Tejas maintains one of the world's best safety records among contemporary fighter aircraft. As a standard operating procedure, the issue is being analysed in depth, and HAL is working closely with the IAF for a speedy resolution."

However, the company did not offer any details of the technical incident, though news reports stated that LCA Tejas suffered structural damage beyond repair.

SHARES DOWN

Shares of HAL were down 5 per cent when trading opened on Monday following news report of the LCA Tejas

incident, which is the third after the crashes during the Dubai Aero Show in November 2025 and near Jaisalmer, Rajasthan, in March 2024.

HAL has come under scrutiny for missing deadlines on delivery of the LCA Tejas Mk1A primarily due to supply delay of GE-404 engines and weapon and radar sensors' integration with fighter aircrafts. The top brass of the HAL and the IAF will meet again in April to review the progress on the issues identified during the previous meeting in November.

HAL sources said that weapon integration and extensive firing had been completed and so has radar fitting on the aircraft body, as per requirement of the IAF, but some more issues are yet to be resolved. Those can be addressed later even after the induction of the LCA Mk1A, they said.

TN Cabinet clears incentives for 46 projects, bringing in ₹31,592 crore

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu Cabinet on Monday approved incentives for 46 projects, with a committed investment of ₹31,592 crore and 61,521 jobs, according to a government release.

The projects will be spread across Tamil Nadu.

DIVERSE SECTORS

Key investments include Sakthi Aircraft Industry's training aircraft component assembly and maintenance facility; electronics manufacturing projects by Dixon Technologies and SFO Technologies; Vikram Solar's battery energy storage system (BESS) assembly unit; Schneider Electric Group's refrigeration equipment manufacturing facility; Bharat Biotech Group's life sciences products park; Caterpillar Inc Group's construction machinery and equipment manufacturing unit; Boeing's advanced aerospace research and development centre; and Saint-Gobain's glass products manufacturing, among others across multiple sectors, the release said.

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thehindu businessline.

Tamil Nadu voter list trimmed to 5.67 cr after SIR; 74 lakh names deleted

Our Bureau
Chennai

Poll-bound Tamil Nadu now has 5.67 crore voters, following the deletion of nearly 74 lakh names from the voter list in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of Electoral Rolls, 2026.

Before the SIR exercise, the State's electorate stood at 6.41 crore. The final electoral roll published on Monday comprises 2.77 crore male voters, 2.89 crore female voters and 7,617 third-genders, Chief Electoral Officer Archana Patnaik told reporters. There are 12.51 lakh in the 18-19 group, the first time voters, 4.63 lakh persons with disabilities and 3.99 lakh senior citizens in the 85 and above segment, she said.

The SIR was conducted between October 27, 2025 and February 23, 2026. The draft roll published on December 19, 2025 had 5.43 crore voters. During the claims and objec-



Tamil Nadu Chief Electoral Officer Archana Patnaik addressing the media after the publication of the final electoral roll, at the Secretariat in Chennai on Monday

tions period from December 19, 2025 to January 30, 2026, 27.53 lakh eligible voters were added, while 4.23 lakh ineligible names were deleted, she said.

As per the final electoral roll, the constituency with the highest number of electors is Sholinganallur Assembly Constituency in Chengalpattu district with 5.36 lakh vote base (male: 2.62 lakh; female: 2.74 lakh; and third gender: 116). The next highest is Avadi Assembly Constituency in Thiruvallur district with 4.28

lakh electors (male: 2.09 lakh; female: 2.19 lakh; third gender: 75).

LOWEST NUMBER

The lowest number of electors are in Harbour Assembly Constituency in Chennai district with 1.16 lakh voters (male: 58,221; female: 58,620; third gender: 55). The second lowest is Egmore (SC) Assembly Constituency of Chennai district with 1.34 lakh electors (male: 65,677; female: 69,149; third gender: 53), said a state-ment from the EC.

Anti-submarine vessel Anjadip to be inducted into Navy on Feb 27

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Navy is set to enhance its capabilities with the commissioning of *Anjadip*, the third of the eight anti-submarine warfare shallow water craft (ASW-SWC) project, at Chennai port on February 27.

Built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE), Kolkata, *Anjadip*, named after the historically significant island off the coast of Karwar, is specifically designed to address the challenges of the littoral combat environment — the coastal and shallow waters vital for the nation's security, as per a Navy spokesperson.

The commissioning ceremony will be presided over by Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi, Chief of the Naval Staff, said the spokesperson.

IATA agents seek extension of domestic airfare cap

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

The IATA Agents Association of India (IAAI) has urged the Centre to continue with the existing domestic airfare caps to promote tourism and strengthen regional connectivity.

Despite India being the world's fastest-growing aviation market, domestic airfares had become highly volatile and frequently unaffordable due to aggressive dynamic pricing. Such sudden fare spikes directly harm tourism, disrupt family and business travel and weaken regional connectivity, IAAI said in a representation to the Union Ministers of Civil Aviation and Tourism.

Highlighting India's vast and underutilised domestic tourism potential, IAAI said



that affordable and predictable airfares are critical to connect tier-2, -3 and remote destinations in line with the UDAN vision.

FARE CAP

The erratic fares, often exceeding comparable international routes, undermine States' investments in tourism infrastructure, erode passenger confidence and suppress demand.

SRI VARAHA LAKSHMI NARASIMHA SWAMY VARI DEVASTHANAM
SIMHACHALAM VISAKHAPATNAM DISTRICT, A.P. - 530028.
PH: 8008129195 / 7396164484, Email - endow-eosvlnsd@gov.in
AMENDMENT
As per the R.C.No: SVLNSD-LEASOC3/1/2026-SA(C3), Dt.07.02.2026 advertisement given E-Tender - Sealed tender cum public auction for Human Hair schedule to be conducted on 23.02.2026 is postponed due to Administrative reasons. The Public auction will be conducted on 09.03.2026 and the e-procurement technical bid, price bid will be opened on 09.03.2026.
Sd/- J. Venkata Rao, Executive Officer

WhatsApp denies data sharing claims at Supreme Court hearing

FOLLOWING THE RULES. Instant messaging platform pledges to comply with user consent regulations by 2026

The Hindu Bureau
New Delhi

Instant messaging platform WhatsApp maintained in the Supreme Court on Monday that it is not “quite right” to say the online entity is sharing data with other Meta platforms.

Appearing before a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, senior advocate Kapil Sibal, for WhatsApp and parent company Meta, said its technology was very clear and put a premium on privacy. “There is no question of violating the law,” Sibal said.

He further said the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023, comprehensively addressed the pri-

vacy concerns raised in the Supreme Court.

The court was hearing petitions filed by Meta and WhatsApp against a National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) decision to uphold a ₹213.14 crore penalty imposed by the Competition Commission of India (CCI).

MARKET DOMINANCE The CCI had found WhatsApp’s ‘take-it-or-leave-it’ approach in its 2021 privacy policy an abuse of its market dominance. It found the prior consent sought from users to share data with Meta “manufactured”. It concluded that users were forced to share data for continued access to WhatsApp messaging services.



POWER PLAY. The CCI had found WhatsApp’s ‘take-it-or-leave-it’ approach an abuse of its market dominance

In an appeal last year, the NCLAT concluded that the “core principle is to remove exploitation by restoring user choice”. On Monday, WhatsApp said it would fully comply with the NCLAT directions relating to user consent for sharing data with parent company Meta under its controversial 2021 privacy policy by March 16, 2026. WhatsApp filed a comprehensive affidavit explaining its technology of end-to-end encryption, following scathing oral remarks from the Bench in the previous hearing on February 3.

RIGHT TO PRIVACY The Bench cautioned that it

would not permit the platform and Meta to breach the right to privacy of millions of their “silent consumers” in India through the sharing and commercial exploitation of personal data. It even compared sharing of private data to a “decent way of committing theft”.

COMPETITION LAW Senior advocate Madhavi Goradia Divan, for CCI, said there was also a competition law concern attached to the case.

“Data-sharing has many facets. One may be privacy and data protection. But there is another aspect, protecting market and consumer, which stands on a totally different footing,” Divan submitted.

AgniKul Cosmos achieves triple engine launch breakthrough

Our Bureau
Chennai



MISSION SUCCESS. More engines improve the rocket’s performance, and a three-engine system is needed for the launch of commercial missions, said Srinath Ravichandran, CEO, AgniKul

Chennai-based space start-up AgniKul Cosmos has successfully test-fired three semi-cryogenic rocket engines simultaneously — a first-of-its-kind achievement when it comes to the firing of three semi-cryogenic engines together as a cluster in India.

The electric pump-fed engines were designed and manufactured in-house at AgniKul Cosmos Rocket Factory-1.

COMMERCIAL MISSIONS Srinath Ravichandran, Co-Founder and Chief Executive Officer at AgniKul, said that more engines improve the rocket’s performance, and a three-engine system is needed for the launch of commercial missions.

“This test involved calibrating six pumps, six motors and tuning six speed control algorithms to work together in perfect sync to achieve uniform start-up, steady state and shutdown performance across the entire system,” the start-up said in a post on X.

Ravichandran said that the company will be working to push this number of engines higher, and the actual

Air India plans to expand Australia flights

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi



DAILY SERVICES. At present, the airline operates flights from Delhi to Melbourne and Sydney

The Tata Group-promoted Air India is planning to expand its presence in Australia with new flights either to Adelaide or Brisbane in 2026, sources told *businessline*.

At present, the airline operates flights from Delhi to Melbourne and Sydney, with daily services to both destinations. Speaking to *businessline*, sources said the proposed service is expected to be operated using Air India’s refurbished Boeing 787 aircraft.

THE TIMELINE Notably, the timeline for such flights depends on the return of these aircraft to service from Air India’s on-

going exercise of refitting them with new interiors.

Meanwhile, the airline is expected to receive around five new wide-body aircraft in 2026. When contacted, Air India did not respond to *businessline*’s queries.

Besides, Air India intends to introduce its upgraded premium product line-up on routes to the United States, Australia, Canada and European cities.

PREMIUM PRODUCTS The airline offers premium products on flights to New York, London and Frankfurt, which are operated on Boe-

ing 777, some Boeing 787 and Airbus A350 aircraft. Among the three major long-haul markets, Australia is expected to see new flights operated on refurbished or up-graded aircraft.

PROPOSED SERVICES Sources indicated that the proposed Australian services may be operated from Mumbai and Bengaluru, in line with the airline’s strategy to strengthen multiple metro hubs and distribute long-haul operations beyond Delhi.

Apart from Australia, Air India is also evaluating additional long-haul opportunities, including potential new services to Johannesburg and Jakarta and higher frequencies to Tokyo as part of its medium-term network growth plans, sources added.

CDSCO cracks down on poor drug quality

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai



Rajeev Raghuvanshi, Drugs Controller General of India

Without quality, it is not possible to undertake innovation, said Drugs Controller General of India (DCGI) Rajeev Raghuvanshi, outlining a slew of measures from the drug regulator, including notices to manufacturers making not-of-standard-quality (NSQ) products, tightening the noose around errant cough syrup makers and creating a flexi-pool of scientific talent within the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO).

In the last 10 months, the regulatory authority has issued 850 CAPA (corrective and preventive action) notices to manufacturing facilities that are in the dock for making NSQ products, the

companies adhered to the revised good manufacturing practices (GMP) norms, he said the regulator was not accepting responses just as a formality, and that the message was clear — “either learn or move out”.

The DCGI was speaking at the Quality Summit of the Indian Pharmaceutical Alliance, a platform representing large domestic drug-makers.

From January 2026, the last leg of the revised GMP kicked-in — for the small- and medium-sized drug-makers as well.

Separately, he said, the regulatory authority had physically checked 90 per cent of the 1,300 facilities making cough syrups and action was taken against those that did not make the cut, in line with the seriousness of their transgressions.

“The rot of cough syrup manufacturing will be removed from next season,” he said.

SCIENTIFIC CADRE Pointing to the reference in Budget 2026 on strengthening the CDSCO, the DCGI said a flexi-pool of 1,500 scientific experts was being created to support clinical activities of the regulatory body.

Besides creating an NSQ dashboard that gives a compliance-linked profile of the company involved, he said, a revamp of the governance-related Sugam platform would be undertaken to reflect all aspects of the regulatory value chain.

The ₹100 crore project had got the green signal from the Centre, the DCGI told *businessline*.

thehindubusinessline.



Women: Pillar of the Rural Economy

The fifth edition of *the hindu businessline*’s Agri and Commodity Summit 2026 is focussed on women and their significant role in India’s rural economy.

Celebrating the International Year of Women Farmers, the event will feature engaging discussions on women’s empowerment in agriculture and the financial challenges faced by women farmers. The event will also spotlight inspiring success stories of women who have made significant strides in agriculture.

The grand finale will be a fireside chat with a distinguished agribusiness CEO.

Friday, February 27, 2026
9:30 AM - 5:00 PM

LIMITED REGISTRATIONS ONLY

The Leela Palace, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi

To register, visit
thbl.news/AGRS2026PA
or scan the QR code



SESSION LINE-UP



10.30 AM
Inaugural Address
Devesh Chaturvedi
Secretary, Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare, Government of India



10.40 AM
Special Address
Shaji K. V.
Chairman, NABARD

Session 1 : 11:15 AM
Silent Architects of the Rural Economy
Sarbani Bose, CoE Lead, Gender Equality, PRADAN
Chhavi Rajawat, Former Sarpanch, Soda Village, Rajasthan (2010-2020)
Sanjiv Kanwar, Managing Director, Yara South Asia and Country Head, Yara India
Kalyani Singh, Entrepreneur, Better Life Farming Alliance
Moderated by Shishir Sinha, Associate Editor, *the hindu businessline*

Session 2 : 12:00 NOON
Seeds of Funding
Anupam Gupta, CBO, Kissandhan
Tarana, Farmer, Arakote Valley, Uttarakhand
Ravi Kumar, Lead-Smallholder Farming, South-East Asia, Bayer AG
Ajay Kumar Jha, Deputy General Manager (Product Development and Marketing), State Bank of India
Moderated by Subramani Ra Mancombu, Consulting Editor, *the hindu businessline*

Session 3 : 12:45 PM
From Field Work to Entrepreneurship
Aruna Debbarma, Lakhpati Didi, Tripura Rural Livelihood Mission
Vaishali Ghuge, Member, Swayam Shikshan Prayog
Moderated by Richa Mishra, Resident Editor, Hyderabad, *the hindu businessline*

Session 4 : 3:00 PM
Precious Metals: Beyond Aam Aadmi’s Reach
Kavita Chacko, Research Head, India, World Gold Council
Jateen N Trivedi, VP, Commodity and Currency Research, LKP Securities
Moderated by Lokeshwarri S K, Data Editor, *the hindu businessline*

Session 5 : 3:45 PM
Fireside Chat
Brahmani Nara, Executive Director, Heritage Foods,
with **Raghuvir Srinivasan**, Editor, *the hindu businessline*

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TUESDAY - FEBRUARY 24 - 2026

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI
20 Microcons [5]	178.76	178.86	180.28	181.00	177.45	61.89	284.80	160.05	11	17.815
30 Irons One WAM	1100.60	1126.90	1110.00	1110.00	1090.10	793.30	1273.80	790.50		
38 SPAC [5]	328.83	319.93	323.85	325.95	316.05	61.38	431.80	287.95	23	318.15
65 MoatsTe [2]	641.90	585.49	642.00	646.00	576.55	391.32	1180.00	575.05	64	585.20
A										
Aadhar Hsg	479.35	470.00	479.00	484.95	467.70	462.96	547.80	361.60		
Aakash Exp	8.61	8.82	8.77	9.20	8.61	388.93	13.79	7.06		
Aarey Drugs	86.00	84.00	85.99	86.37	79.23	782.00	100.00	91.35		
Adani Ports	372.30	372.30	372.30	372.30	369.00	10.55	174.95	31.10	18	371.65
Adani Infra	450.65	446.70	454.00	457.00	441.20	536.59	494.00	338.20	44	445.70
Adani Pharm	678.95	686.90	700.00	709.75	682.90	208.68	971.00	574.45		
Adani Infra	1280.00	1285.50	1291.60	1298.60	1264.20	181.28	2238.35	1261.00		1285.90
AB Capital	344.85	346.20	345.15	350.95	342.85	8310.98	369.25	150.00	30	346.30
AB InPharma	21.68	20.82	23.56	23.56	20.26	6125.70	22.98	17.50		
AB Real Est	1300.90	1304.60	1301.00	1317.50	1292.70	70.26	2537.90	1186.00		
ABB [2]	91.95	91.05	91.05	91.05	90.75	10.00	10.00	10.00		
ABB [2]	590.07	591.75	600.00	609.00	577.00	831.00	6239.80	459.00	75	591.65
ABP Power	2387.10	2404.60	2381.00	2400.00	2387.00	12.31	24370.00	10400.00		
ABP Power	2628.00	2649.00	2620.00	2650.00	2620.00	12.31	25915.00	2600.00		2647.15
ABFL	69.85	69.48	69.80	72.45	69.00	3678.75	10.71	59.82		69.68
ACC	161.60	161.80	162.80	162.80	161.00	96.02	2123.30	1594.50	12	161.65
ACCELVIA	1183.00	1166.94	1194.00	1194.00	1160.30	3.67	1524.55	1152.05	15	1165.50
ACME Solar	11.00	11.00	11.00	11.00	11.00	11.00	11.00	11.00		
Acta Cons [2]	86.14	87.75	86.60	88.55	86.60	137.75	130.00	77.50	24	87.85
Actuata Cons	2106.24	2160.28	2163.00	2165.00	2115.00	37.35	2553.50	2165.00		
Adani Ports	1511.50	1555.80	1518.00	1564.50	1510.80	113.73	1584.00	1303.55	18	1556.65
Adani Pwr [2]	142.20	145.65	145.15	145.65	142.40	9058.84	18.25	33.23	27	144.00
Adani T Gas	52.90	52.50	52.90	53.10	52.15	24.00	78.00	10.10		
Adani Wilam	198.52	199.65	20.15	20.15	195.31	1396.62	19.20	194.79		
Adani E.Sol	109.10	109.30	109.10	101.00	99.15	1266.71	106.70	639.45		
Adani Infra	228.10	228.10	228.10	228.10	228.10	228.10	228.10	228.10	27	227.80
AdityaBirla	10.46	10.68	10.84	10.34	10.57	458.88	17.05	10.86		
AdityaBirla	1499.50	1504.88	1548.00	1548.00	1492.10	11.89	147.10	1015.00		
AdityaBirla	486.25	486.25	486.25	486.25	486.25	486.25	486.25	486.25		
AdityaBirla	1080.10	1073.40	1085.90	1090.00	1065.30	15.34	1260.00	788.00		
Advant Ener	1736.90	1700.40	1751.70	1770.00	1692.40	18.45	1885.00	1351.00		
Advantage Aero	134.56	131.07	137.19	137.19	125.00	47.00	154.00	102.00		
Advantia [2]	20.23	20.23	20.23	20.23	20.23	20.23	20.23	20.23		
Advantia [2]	31.95	31.93	31.93	31.93	31.93	31.93	31.93	31.93	28	31.930
Aegis Log [1]	693.05	702.40	691.00	707.00	691.00	241.37	946.50	657.85	38	703.60
Aegion Pharma	10.00	10.00	10.00	10.00	10.00	10.00	10.00	10.00		
Aegion Pharma	144.74	139.22	145.00	145.00	138.18	73.69	156.00	131.14		
Aeroflex Ind	23.30	22.02	23.23	22.99	21.65	14.12	23.99	14.01		
Aeroflex Ind	78.61	78.95	78.61	79.90	77.91	17.93	113.90	72.14		
Aeroflex Ind	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62		80.75
Aeroflex Ind	32.00	31.90	32.00	32.15	31.55	260.83	48.70	31.55		
Affle [2]	1486.20	1509.60	1500.00	1527.70	1499.00	21.56	2186.80	1221.05	167	1509.65
Affle [2]	228.10	228.10	228.10	228.10	228.10	228.10	228.10	228.10	27	228.10
Agri Greenpac	57.25	56.85	58.00	59.90	56.60	104.26	100.00	59.20		
Agri Infra	278.35	275.45	274.00	296.00	270.25	262.77	98.00	226.75		
Alghuani [2]	80.75	80.55	80.75	81.00	80.25	59.01	112.20	62.70		
Alghuani [2]	394.90	394.90	394.90	394.90	394.90	394.90	394.90	394.90		394.90
Alghuani [2]	2939.40	2978.40	2940.00	2990.00	2936.70	20.67	3020.40	2022.05	40	2977.90
Alghuani [2]	484.85	491.00	495.00	496.55	486.05	42.88	756.00	465.00		
Alghuani [2]	52.90	52.50	52.90	53.10	52.15	24.00	78.00	10.10		
Alghuani [2]	5.88	5.75	6.19	7.05	5.94	131.47	9.00	3.92		
Alghuani [2]	478.35	474.00	481.00	482.90	468.90	132.44	62.95	405.00		
Alghuani [2]	3054.00	3086.10	3079.00	3092.00	3042.00	25.07	3079.00	2560.00	37	3090.50
Alghuani [2]	73.05	73.05	73.05	73.05	73.05	73.05	73.05	73.05	30	77.05
Alghuani [2]	93.96	94.76	94.05	95.90	93.96	146.12	10.70	85.55	18	94.76
Alghuani [2]	58.04	60.15	59.00	62.24	57.98	2023.91	7.01	56.00		
Alghuani [2]	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	34	80.125
Alghuani [2]	91.95	91.95	91.95	91.95	91.95	91.95	91.95	91.95		
Alghuani [2]	59.00	59.35	91.85	92.05	89.07	51.23	122.50	81.00		
Alghuani [2]	5392.00	5490.50	5415.00	5504.00	5395.50	139.37	5933.00	4488.90	30	5492.25
Alghuani [2]	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00		
Alghuani [2]	8.78	8.64	9.02	9.02	8.60	5557.43	1.88	8.14		8.67
Alghuani [2]	25.34	25.78	25.24	26.09	25.34	14.68	40.01	21.21		
Alghuani [2]	85.92	85.95	85.92	86.55	85.92	81.00	12.00	1084.00	77.00	
Alghuani [2]	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	50	121.45
Alghuani [2]	50.80	50.45	50.50	50.80	49.88	115.77	69.80	27.90		
Alghuani [2]	14.72	14.78	14.95	15.32	14.60	6916.03	2.35	14.00		
Alghuani [2]	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00		
Alghuani [2]	85.25	85.07	85.75	87.00	85.40	365.10	110.00	84.00		
Alghuani [2]	7650.00	7770.07	7675.00	7899.07	7650.00	332.98	8625.00	5100.00	188	7768.20
Alghuani [2]	1400.00	1402.00	1401.00	1430.00	1392.00	8.36	1700.00	1160.00	13	1401.05
Alghuani [2]	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00		
Alghuani [2]	30.00	30.67	30.00	30.70	30.00	150.23	425.00	1594.00		
Alghuani [2]	525.40	513.25	528.00	530.00	507.55	289.98	79.86	431.00		
Alghuani [2]	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	69	80.125
Alghuani [2]	59.00	59.35	91.85	92.05	89.07	51.23	122.50	100.22		
Alghuani [2]	68.31	68.51	68.01	69.00	67.95	102.90	9.00	61.16		
Alghuani [2]	2496.24	2540.24	2524.00	2600.00	2496.24	25.07	2540.24	2524.00	37	2540.24
Alghuani [2]	12.27	12.27	12.27	12.27	12.27	12.27	12.27	12.27		
Alghuani [2]	61.30	59.89	61.30	61.30	61.30	61.30	61.30	61.30		
Alghuani [2]	68.19	69.35	68.35	69.35	68.19	66.69	87.95	57.91		
Alghuani [2]	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76		
Alghuani [2]	50.80	50.45	50.50	50.80	49.88	115.77	69.80	27.90		
Alghuani [2]	14.72	14.78	14.95	15.32	14.60	6916.03	2.35	14.00		
Alghuani [2]	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00		
Alghuani [2]	85.25	85.07	85.75	87.00	85.40	365.10	110.00	84.00		
Alghuani [2]	7650.00	7770.07	7675.00	7899.07	7650.00	332.98	8625.00	5100.00	188	7768.20
Alghuani [2]	1400.00	1402.00	1401.00	1430.00	1392.00	8.36	1700.00	1160.00	13	1401.05
Alghuani [2]	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00		
Alghuani [2]	30.00	30.67	30.00	30.70	30.00	150.23	425.00	1594.00		
Alghuani [2]	525.40	513.25	528.00	530.00	507.55	289.98	79.86	431.00		
Alghuani [2]	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	80.62	69	80.125
Alghuani [2]	59.00	59.35	91.85	92.05	89.07	51.23	122.50	100.22		
Alghuani [2]	68.31	68.51	68.01	69.00	67.95	102.90	9.00	61.16		
Alghuani [2]	2496.24	2540.24	2524.00	2600.00	2496.24	25.07	2540.24	2524.00	37	2540.24
Alghuani [2]	12.27	12.27	12.27	12.27	12.27	12.27	12.27	12.27		
Alghuani [2]	61.30	59.89	61.30	61.30	61.30	61.30	61.30	61.30		
Alghuani [2]	68.19	69.35	68.35	69.35	68.19	66.69	87.95	57.91		
Alghuani [2]	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76	124.76		
Alghuani [2]	50.80	50.45	50.50	50.80	49.88	115.77	69.80	27.90		
Alghuani [2]	14.72	14.78	14.95	15.32	14.60	6916.03	2.35	14.00		
Alghuani [2]	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00		
Alghuani [2]	85.25	85.07	85.75	87.00	85.40	365.10	110.00	84.00		
Alghuani [2]										

